



THE SCEPTER OF TYR

A Dungeons & Dragons 5e adventure

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The Scepter of Tyr

dark fantasy, moral choices

D&D 5e (2014)

Level 8-10

Duration: campaign (4 modules, 8-12 sessions)

Structure: linear

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△ Auto-translated from Italian. The Italian version is the source of truth.

The Scepter of Tyr

Lore

Lo Scettro di Tyr is a divine weapon said to have been wielded by Tyr himself. Only the pure can use it without suffering the curse that consumes the soul and transforms the bearer into an undead servant. The Scepter was lost during the **Fall of the Temple of Lumina**, when a priest corrupted by Vecna attempted to steal it. **Ormut**, a spellcaster devoted to Tyr, teleported it to an unknown location — the **Kingdom of Erythale**, an ethereal plane of light and crystal — before dying at the hands of the traitors.

Since then, the Scepter has become the stuff of legends. **Vecna**, the God of Secrets, wants it to amplify his dark power and transform humanity into undead servants. The **Custodi dell'Equilibrio**, an order dedicated to Tyr, want to recover it for their leader **Sir Alaric il Giusto** — who hides personal ambitions of absolute power.

The saga takes place along the Sword Coast and beyond, from **Orcastle** (a prison-city under a magical dome) to the frozen lands of **Svoalbard** north of Bryn Shander.

Introduction

"I owe you my life. My wrath shall fall upon you if you do not begin searching for Lo Scettro di Tyr. Immeasurable rewards will be bestowed upon you if you accomplish the task."

The characters find themselves caught in a chain of events that takes them from forced service to a tyrant (Malebranche) to a mission on behalf of Vecna, until they must choose sides in a conflict between deities. Their moral choices determine the fate of entire kingdoms.

The adventure begins with the PCs being kidnapped by **Lord Cedric Malebranche**, who forces them to recover the **Pergamena del Giudizio** in the prison-city of Orcastle. From there, a pact with **Vecna** sends them on a quest for Lo Scettro di Tyr. The journey takes them through mountains, ruined temples, and alternate planes of existence, to the final showdown.

General Plot

- **Module A — Escape from Orcastle:** the PCs, kidnapped and fitted with explosive collars, must recover the Pergamena del Giudizio in the prison-city of Orcastle and find a way to escape. Four factions control the island, each with their own secrets.
- **Module B — Lo Scettro di Tyr:** Vecna tasks the PCs with recovering the Scepter from the Temple of Lumina. Journey from Baldur's Gate through dangerous mountains, trials of purity in the temple, and a final confrontation with Alaric il Giusto.
- **Module C — Return Home:** the PCs must deliver the Scepter to the altar of Tyr in Svoalbard. Sea voyage along the Sword Coast, pursued by a spy of Vecna and the warlock Othran Vorash.
- **Module D — The End Does Not Belong to the Dead:** Malebranche, defeated, summons the wizard Zikle and curses the PCs. The dead rise wherever they go. They must find the Monile d'Oro di Ostegard to break the curse and defeat Malebranche once and for all.

DM Advice

- **Tone:** dark fantasy with moments of moral tension. The PCs start on the side of evil (working for Vecna) and must earn their redemption. Moral choices have real mechanical consequences.
- **Continuity:** the modules are sequential. Characters like Frankie, Ombrascura, Kreig, Miranda, and Ruby return in different modules. Keep track of relationships.
- **Vecna:** is always present as a threat. If the PCs ignore his requests, they suffer progressive curses (d6 table in Module B). He is not an enemy to fight directly — he is a puppeteer.
- **The Scepter:** is an extremely powerful but dangerous object. Tyr's curse strikes anyone who touches it without being pure. Only the designated herald can wield it. Keep track of who carries it and the consequences.
- **Difficulty:** the adventure scales from lv8 (Module A) to lv10 (Modules C-D). Encounters are calibrated for 4-6 PCs. Module A has many non-combat options; Module D is the most combat-heavy.

Main NPCs

Full character sheets in [characters/markdown/](#).

Allies and Companions

- **Frankie Partenope** — human barbarian lv5, former adventurer and folk hero. Forced to cooperate with the PCs in Module A (explosive collar). Hates Malebranche. Returns in Module D as an ally.
- **Malachias Ombrascuro** (alias Elemir Strunz) — dragonborn cleric, stole the Pergamena del Giudizio. Hides in Orcastle under a false identity. Returns in Module D.
- **Brother Thaddeus** — monk, former disciple of Tyr. Left the order after discovering Alaric's true intentions. Offers crucial information in Module B.
- **Ludmilla Dawnshield** — human explorer, descendant of the first explorers of Svoalbard. Guides the PCs to the island in Module C.
- **Helmut Van Heuten** — merchant devoted to Tyr, finances and supports the mission in Module C.

Antagonists

- **Lord Cedric Malebranche** — archmage necromancer, corrupt governor. Mastermind behind the kidnapping in Module A. Final villain in Module D.
- **Sir Alaric il Giusto** — high priest of the Custodi dell'Equilibrio. Hides ambitions of absolute power. Antagonist of Module B.
- **Othran Vorash** — half-elf warlock of Vecna, lv10. Pursues the PCs to steal the Scepter in Modules C-D.
- **Zalhara Lorenn** — human spy in the service of Vecna. Travels on the same ship as the PCs in Module C.

Orcastle Factions (Module A)

- **Axel Ruby** — leader of the Ruby gang (east), former vassal of Malebranche.
- **Miranda Emerald** — leader of the Emerald gang (west), illusionist mage.
- **Lord Kreig Highlander** — leader of the Castro (center), secret cousin of Malebranche. Becomes count in Module D.

Deities and Entities

- **Vecna** — God of Secrets. Manipulator, does not fight directly. Appears as an avatar at the Torre di Torth.
- **Tyr** — God of Justice. Appears at the Temple of Lumina and in Svoalbard. Poses trials of purity.

Secondary Characters

- **Mesusu Merconè** — dwarf, captain of the flying ship Airborne.
- **Kurzum** — dwarf, owner of the Giavellotto Fantasma, mission broker.

- **Zikle l'Illuminato** — goblin wizard, creator of the Pergamena del Giudizio. Killed by Malebranche, summoned as a wraith in Module D.
- **Tungsten** — dwarf, former adventuring companion of the PCs (friendly NPC already known from previous adventures). Left the adventuring life, moved to the Sword Coast, and opened the tavern *All'orco che rutta* in Waterdeep. Marries Grimilda in the Module D epilogue.
- **Orlomm Glittergear** — gnome, captain of the ship *La Nuova Speranza* (Module C).
- **Tungsten** — former herald, groom at the wedding in the epilogue (Module D).

Key Items

La Pergamena del Giudizio (Module A)

Contains the spell to bring down the magical dome of Orcastle. Protected by a curse: only a paladin or a character pure of heart can activate it (plus the secret word known to Ombrascura). Also includes a message spell with the password “Zikle l'Illuminato”.

Lo Scettro di Tyr (Modules B-C)

Divine crystal weapon. Properties: Sacred Resurrection (1 charge), Empowerment of Justice (+2 to hit, necrotic/psychic resistance, advantage vs fear within 30 feet), Shield of Purity (1/day, halves damage for 3 turns), Sentence of Tyr (1/day, paralysis + truth). Curse: anyone who touches it without Tyr's consent suffers nightmares, halved healing, maximum HP halved each day until death or repentance.

La Coppa di Blackwood (Module A)

Artifact in the Torre di Torth. Functions as Dispel Magic (powerful enough for the collars). Magic word: “Obloc Vecnal” (Praise Vecna in Infernal).

Il Monile d'Oro di Ostegard (Module D)

Talisman that channels sacred energy to disperse necromantic corruption. Kept in the Sunken Sanctuary of Ostegard, guarded by Sir Aldric (sword wraith).

Adventure Structure

#	name	level	type	file
A	Escape from Orcastle	lv8, 5-6 PCs	sandbox / exploration	01_FugaDaOrcastle/ FugaDaOrcastle.md
B	Lo Scettro di Tyr	lv9, 4-5 PCs	travel / dungeon	02_LoScettroDiTyr/ LoScettroDiTyr.md
C	Return Home	lv10, 4-5 PCs	travel / intrigue	03_RitornoACasa/ RitornoACasa.md
D	The End Does Not Belong to the Dead	lv10, 5-6 PCs	travel / combat	04_LaFineNonAppartieneAiMorti/ LaFineNonAppartieneAiMorti.md

Future Hooks

- The pact with Vecna at the Torre di Torth (Module A) can be a hook for subsequent adventures
- The three good deeds required by Tyr to become pure (Module B) can be hooks for one-shots
- Tyr's final voice in Svoalbard (Module C) promises a future call against Vecna
- Tungsten's wedding (Module D epilogue) is a natural starting point for new adventures

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Module 1: Escape from Orcastle

Description

The air reeks of salt and desperation. Below you, a fortress-island wrapped in a semi-transparent magical dome stands against the grey sea. Orcastle — once a center of power and trade, now an open-air prison where criminals, rebels, and dissidents are locked away forever. No one enters, no one leaves, except through the controlled flights of Malebranche's flying ships.

The city-state of Orcastle has been transformed into an open-air prison, surrounded by an impenetrable magical barrier. The corrupt governor Lord Cedric Malebranche has built his power by exploiting this cruel system, imprisoning political enemies and dealing in the shadows with the worst criminals of the region.

Malebranche has lost an ancient artifact, the Pergamena del Giudizio, which contains information capable of overturning his rule. The scroll ended up in the hands of Malachias Ombrascura, a dragonborn cleric hiding among the ruins of Orcastle. Malebranche has kidnapped the PCs and forced them, via explosive collars, to recover the scroll for him. If they fail, they die. If they succeed, they will receive 2500 gold pieces — but Ombrascura has his own plans.

The island is divided into four zones controlled by different factions: East (Ruby gang), West (Emerald gang), North (Torre di Torth, infested with monsters), and Center (Castro degli Highlander). The PCs will need to navigate between these factions, discover where the scroll is hidden, and find a way to escape the island.

Sandbox adventure for 5-6 PCs of level 8.

Objective

Stated: Recover the Pergamena del Giudizio on behalf of Malebranche and deliver it in exchange for the removal of the explosive collars and 2500 gold pieces.

Actual: The PCs will have to decide who to deliver the scroll to — Malebranche, Ombrascura, or use it for their own purposes — and find a way to escape Orcastle before the collars explode (seventh long rest).

Internal Locations

The Kidnapping and the Flying Ship Airborne

The dwarf Kurzum, owner of the Giavellotto Fantasma (weapons shop), offers the PCs a reward of 2500 gp for a blind mission. The only detail: “you won’t like it.”

At the end of another adventure, or during a moment of outdoor rest, anyone with a passive Perception of at least 15 sees a shadow against the sun. A Perception check at DC 12 reveals a flying object approaching rapidly.

A powerful sleep spell hits the group. The character with the most hit points manages to see, before collapsing, the flying machine Airborne landing and a garrison of dozens of soldiers surrounding the group.

You awaken in a narrow corridor, resembling the interior of an airship. Side cabins open along the walls, and at the far end a larger room — the command bridge. You no longer have weapons, armor, or equipment. Around your neck you feel an annoying metal collar that you don’t remember putting on.

The dwarf **Mesusu Merconè**, captain of the ship, invites them to sit. Five armed guards are present (stats: veterans). Mesusu explains:

- The collars will kill them if they disobey or leave the fortress before finding the scroll
- They agreed to the mission on behalf of Malebranche, brokered by Kurzum
- They must find the Pergamena del Giudizio, stolen by Ombrascura
- No one will come to pick them up: it’s too dangerous. The ships patrol the skies and parachute supplies once a month onto the outer peninsula to the southeast. They only rarely land for guard rotation
- The collars will explode anyway after one week (on the seventh long rest)
- When they deliver the scroll to Malebranche, the collar will be removed and 2500 gp delivered. Malebranche is lawful evil but has no intention of betraying this pact

Mesusu does not reveal, even if questioned, that she can locate the PCs on the island thanks to the collars.

The “specialist” Frankie Partenope is then introduced (see [../..//characters/markdown/NPC_FrankiePartenope.md](#)): a criminal who has already managed to escape from Orcastle. Frankie does not answer any questions before arriving on the island. Mesusu, if questioned, adds only that there is a door in the dome upon arrival and that Ombrascura is a dragonborn.

A Traumatic Beginning — The Fall onto the Island

After a long rest, the PCs are invited to the stern and lined up along the cargo door. Suddenly, without warning, the door opens and they are thrown out of the aircraft while still in flight.

Mesusu, as you plummet, shouts: "Run through the door, it won't stay open for long!"

They fall from 200m / 660ft / 132sq. Every 50m / 165ft / 33sq, ask the PCs if they want to do something. At 50m / 165ft / 33sq altitude they are enveloped by a colored mist: a powerful spell slows the fall. They reach the ground as if falling from 6m / 20ft / 4sq, taking 2d6 damage. With an Acrobatics check at DC 12 they halve the damage.

Before them opens a magical door — a semi-transparent distortion in the dome surrounding the fortress. A squad of 2d4 bandits dressed poorly in red (malnourished, poorly equipped) is approaching quickly: they are 150m / 500ft / 100sq from the door, the PCs are 50m / 165ft / 33sq away. The bandits will take two or three turns to arrive. From above, the Airborne and Malebranche's soldiers exchange crossbow and bow fire with the bandits.

If the bandit squad manages to exit the dome, they are hit from above by the ship's weapons and turn back.

The squad approaches asking who they are and where they come from. With Persuasion or Deception at DC 10, the PCs can convince them they are not a threat and are taken to Axel Ruby. If they fight, when the first bandit reaches half HP they surrender or flee. A bandit captain arrives to parley; three more bandit captains arrive after two turns.

East — The Ruby County

The eastern zone of the island is governed by Axel Ruby, a former vassal of Malebranche imprisoned through a power play. Everyone wears red insignia. Axel hates Miranda Emerald and blames her for his fate.

The PCs meet Axel with a garrison of 2d4 bandits in good shape (stats: bandit captain). Axel does not know that Ombrascura is hiding among his people and knows nothing about the scroll. If they ask for information, he sets a condition: to earn his trust they must bring him an Emerald, alive or dead. If they do, they will become Ruby and can wear the insignia. Until then, bandit-to-bandit respect.

Searching for Ombrascura in the East:

1. If they investigate (tavern, passersby) and ask about mages, they get no direct answers. A bandit (commoner) offers, for payment or if convinced/intimidated, a

piece of information: “I saw mysterious sparks in the last house to the north of the eastern part one night, a week ago.”

2. One of Ruby’s guards knows a dragonborn who goes by Elemir Strunz, seen invoking the gods and making strange gestures.
3. Spells like Detect Thoughts or Telepathic Contact could allow gathering clues about Ombrascura, used on one of the Ruby members or on Ombrascura himself.

West — The Emerald County

Between the east and west counties runs the main road leading to the castro. Guards from opposing factions control the passages. Going toward the castro is allowed for everyone; travelers without insignia can pass fairly easily if they don’t arouse suspicion. Red-marked people are barred from going west and blue-marked from going east.

Frankie was an Emerald: he gets recognized and takes the PCs first to a comrade-in-arms, then to Miranda herself in the lord’s palace in the northern part of the county.

Emerald Assassins: The PCs will be constantly watched and spied upon. The assassins emerge only at the opportune moment, attacking from the shadows with poisoned darts (sleep). They move in groups of 1d6. They do not fight to the death — they try to survive to bring information back to base. If captured and not searched immediately (DC 13), they kill themselves with a powerful poison. Captured ones give information only if tortured or if shown to be useful to Miranda.

Miranda Emerald tells the PCs:

- The same rule applies for her: to become Emerald they must bring a Ruby alive or dead, or one of them must defeat an Emerald champion in single combat without magic (stats: knight, p. 344)
- She knows Ombrascura and could recognize him. She knows the scroll can bring down the walls of Orcastle
- Like everyone, she knows the legend of the Torre di Torth but has no details

To obtain information from Miranda, the PCs will need to win her trust by demonstrating they have something of value or secret knowledge (information about Ombrascura or the scroll).

Clues about the Torre di Torth:

1. By investigating, the PCs discover the existence of a book that outlines, without details, the portal and the ritual. Miranda is willing to give it only if convinced with information or something else. Title: “Il mistero della torre di Torth”
2. Miranda’s chamberlain, if questioned and convinced, knows the story with fewer details and the existence of the book

Center — The Castro degli Highlander

The castro is neutral ground: everyone can enter in small groups. Fighting in the castro between factions is punishable by death. Only people with Ruby (red) or Emerald (blue) insignia can enter, if introduced by someone from the place. The entrance gate is heavily guarded.

In a stable on the right side of the castro were the griffons that Frankie had used to escape, but after his escape many tried to use them: all the griffons have fled or died.

The Pergamena del Giudizio is hidden north of the castro, under the flagpole. Ombrascura can retrieve it but is known as a Ruby, so if accompanied by Emeralds he could arouse suspicion.

If accompanied by Ombrascura, it will be easy to go retrieve the scroll under the flag to the north. Otherwise the PCs will need to:

1. Locate the place
2. Find the concealed compartment at the base of the flagpole — Perception/ Investigation DC 14
3. Open the non-magical lock — HP 80
4. Avoid the magical trap triggered by a glyph

Highlander Soldiers: Well-equipped and disciplined, they rigidly control the central area. Organized patrols will try to capture the PCs if they are spotted.

Lord Kreig Highlander is arrogant and underestimates opponents who do not demonstrate a clear threat. He could be convinced to cooperate only if there is a personal reward. If questioned, the PCs discover he is a distant cousin of Malebranche (therefore able to activate the scroll if he knows the secret word, known to Ombrascura).

North — The Monsters Guarding the Tower

The northern plain is rocky, slightly higher than the rest of the island. The rocks and ridges provide easy cover, partial or total (1d4: 1-3 partial, 4 total).

First Encounter — Cultists of Vecna:

Halfway there, behind a rock, the PCs see a patrol of cultists led by their priest, in the middle of a ritual: they chant a sacred hymn to Vecna in Infernal. All wear a tunic with the symbol of a hand grasping an eye. If encountered (Stealth) they are hostile. They have no willingness to parley: after warning the PCs to leave, they attack and fight to the death. If the PCs flee south, they do not pursue.

Encounter Difficulty: EASY (4 fanatic cultists CR 2 = ~3600 XP adjusted for 5-6 PCs lv8)

name	#	HP	AC	attack	notes
Fanatic Cultist	4	33	13	+4, 1d6+2 dagger + spells	MM p. 346 CR 2. Fight to the death

Second Encounter — Bearded Devils:

After 4 turns or once the cultists are defeated, two bearded devils attempt to surprise the PCs. Group Perception check with disadvantage if they are still in the middle of battle. The devils order them to leave; if the PCs refuse, they fight to the death. Two imps accompany them, hidden and invisible.

Encounter Difficulty: MEDIUM (2 bearded devils CR 5 + 2 imps CR 1 = ~8000 XP adjusted for 5-6 PCs lv8)

name	#	HP	AC	attack	notes
Bearded Devil	2	52	13	+5, 1d10+3 halberd	MM p. 70 CR 5
Imp	2	10	13	+5, 1d4+3 sting + poison	MM p. 76 CR 1. Invisible, attack by surprise

Third Encounter — The Boss:

After two turns or when the devils are defeated, a chain devil appears, cursing the PCs in Infernal in the name of Vecna. Two surviving imps (if present) join him.

Encounter Difficulty: HARD (1 chain devil CR 8 + 2 imps CR 1 = ~8600 XP adjusted for 5-6 PCs lv8)

name	#	HP	AC	attack	notes
Chain Devil	1	85	16	+8, 2d6+4 chain	MM p. 75 CR 8
Imp	2	10	13	+5, 1d4+3 sting + poison	MM p. 76 CR 1. Only if they survived the second encounter

North — The Torre di Torth and the Secret Well

The tower rises menacingly and appears uninhabited. Black stone, a spiral of steep stairs leading to the room at the top. The air is thick with magical energy, and on the walls ancient inscriptions can be seen in a language long lost.

The Torre di Torth is an ancient temple dedicated to Vecna, the god of secrets and dark arts. It was built by the priest Ablunth Torth as a monument to dark power, with blood rituals and sacrifices. A History check at DC 12 reveals the connection between the tower and Vecna: the god of traitors and manipulators, who rewards those who scheme in the shadows.

The inscriptions on the walls can be deciphered only with Comprehend Languages or an Intelligence (Arcana) check at DC 15. They reveal: “Honor to Vecna, Vecna who opens the doors; I raise the chalice and toast to you.”

The room at the top of the tower:

At the top, the PCs find two statues flanking a black stone altar. The statues depict figures wrapped in cloaks wielding scepters, with eyes set with onyx. In front of the altar is a stone basin full of ashes. The air is cold and vibrant with ancient power.

Above the altar, among dozens of other cups, hides the Coppa di Blackwood — needed to open the portal in the basement. If picked up and the inscription in Common on the cup is read (“Dark is the night in the hearts of the just”), Vecna appears.

The Apparition of Vecna:

Vecna appears as an avatar: he only wants to talk, cannot be hit and cannot strike. Amused by the PCs’ efforts, he proposes a pact: he will remove the collar imprisonment if they complete a mission on his behalf (he gives no details). If they accept, he reveals how to use the cup as Dispel Magic. The PCs can also discover this function with Arcana DC 15. Detect Magic reveals only that it is abjuration. The magic word is “Praise Vecna” in Infernal: “Obloc Vecnal”.

The Ritual to Open the Well:

An inscription reads: “Offer your blood, reveal a secret, and finally burn, my child, burn that which is already burned.” A mural depicts the same clues: red drops, a fire, a shadow descending stairs emerging from an open well.

At least two of three steps are needed:

1. **Offer blood:** A PC offers their own blood on the altar (1d6 necrotic damage to themselves). The blood is absorbed by the stone and the basin emits a faint red glow.
2. **Evoke the past:** The group recounts aloud an important memory or a promise tied to the mission. Charisma (Persuasion) or Wisdom (Religion) check at DC 13. If they fail, the statues come to life and attack.
3. **Light the sacred flames:** A fire spell (Fireball, Burning Hands, or similar) must ignite the ashes in the basin. The gems on the statues glow and a loud noise is heard from the foundations.

If the ritual succeeds, the ground beneath the well opens revealing a stone staircase descending into the underground.

The Underground Dungeon of the Tower

You descend through the well into a narrow, dark corridor carved from raw rock. The air is cold and damp, the only sound is your breathing. The walls are covered with ancient runes that emit a faint blue light.

The dungeon consists of three trials protecting access to the portal:

Trial 1 — The Hall of Reflection:

A large hall with a floor polished like a mirror. As soon as the PCs set foot in the room, their doubles emerge from the floor and attack them. The doubles possess the same powers and HP as the original PCs, but are vulnerable to psychic attacks and cannot heal. Detect Magic reveals a powerful illusion spell; the damage dealt by the doubles is psychic.

DM Note: manage the doubles as simplified copies of the PCs — they use only basic attacks (main weapon) and cantrips, not spell slots or class abilities. They have the same HP and AC as the PCs but have no active magic items. The goal of the hall is not a long combat but the discovery that ignoring the doubles is the solution.

To pass the hall, the PCs must ignore the doubles and recite a phrase hidden in the runes on the opposite wall: “The shadow is nothing without the light, the shadow has the power you give it.” Understanding this requires a Wisdom (Insight) or Intelligence (Arcana) check at DC 15. The shadows disappear after wounding at least three characters.

Trial 2 — The Labyrinth of Vecna:

A checkerboard floor appears before the PCs. On each tile there is a letter. They must spell out the word “V.E.C.N.A.” by walking on the correct tiles. For each wrong letter, a poisoned dart deals 2d4+2 piercing damage to all characters (Dexterity saving throw DC 12 to halve).

Trial 3 — The Guardian of the Portal:

In the final hall, the PCs find the Teleportation Portal — an ancient circle of runic stones — guarded by a Stone Golem. The creature protects the portal from anyone who does not have the right to use it.

The PCs can fight the guardian or try to deceive it, convincing it they are the new custodians of the portal with Charisma (Deception) or Wisdom (Persuasion) at DC 18. A convincing roleplay performance grants advantage on the check.

The Teleportation Portal:

Once past the guardian, the portal requires the Coppa di Blackwood found at the top of the tower. A PC who succeeds on Arcana or History DC 15 understands the triggering rite. A fresco on a wall depicts the open portal and a cleric drinking from a cup.

Toasting with the cup in honor of Vecna activates the portal. Any other god would not respond in a tower of this kind.

Once the toast is made, the tower trembles briefly and the PCs find themselves teleported near Malebranche's palace on the mainland.

Enemies

name	#	HP	AC	attack	notes
Bandit (Ruby/Emerald)	variable	11	12	+3, 1d6+1 scimitar	squads of 2d4
Bandit Captain	variable	65	15	+5, 2d6+3	Axel's garrison
Emerald Assassin	1d6	78	15	+6, 1d8+3 shortsword + 7d6 poison	Assassin MM p. 343 CR 8. Poisoned darts (sleep, Constitution saving throw DC 13). Attack by surprise
Knight (Emerald champion)	1	52	18	+5, 2d6+3	p. 344, duel without magic
Highlander Soldier	variable	58	17	+5, 2d8+3 greatsword	Veteran MM p. 350 CR 3. Organized patrols
Cultist of Vecna	8	9	12	+3, 1d6+1 scimitar	p. 345
Fanatic Cultist	1	33	13	+4, 1d6+2 dagger	p. 346
Bearded Devil	2	52	13	+5, 1d10+3 halberd	p. 70
Chain Devil	1	85	16	+8, 2d6+4 chain	p. 75
Stone Golem	1	178	17	+10, 3d8+6 slam	portal guardian
Veteran (Airborne guards)	5	58	17	+5, 2d8+3	Mesusu's escort

Key Clues

1. **Ombrascura is hiding in the East** under the false name Elemir Strunz. He is a dragonborn with a star-shaped scar on his left calf. He lives as a follower of Axel Ruby.
2. **The Pergamena del Giudizio** is hidden in the castro, in the underground beneath the flagpole to the north. Ombrascura put it there.
3. **The scroll** contains three pieces of information: a spell that brings down the invisible walls of Orcastle, a spell to send a message to Malebranche to prove they found it, and the word to send “Zikle l’Illuminato” (name of the creator, a good goblin wizard).
4. **Activating the scroll:** only a paladin, a character pure of heart, or Malebranche and his blood relatives can activate it. The secret phrase “The walls shall fall, the power shall end” must then be spoken, known to Ombrascura.
5. **Miranda Emerald** knows Ombrascura and could recognize him. She possesses the book “Il mistero della torre di Torth”.
6. **Lord Kreig** is a distant cousin of Malebranche — information he has always kept hidden. He could therefore activate the scroll.
7. **The Torre di Torth** hides a teleportation portal in its underground, activatable with the Coppa di Blackwood and a toast to Vecna.
8. **The Coppa di Blackwood** can function as a Dispel Magic powerful enough to remove the collars. The magic word is “Obloc Vecnal” (Praise Vecna in Infernal).

Finale

The Scroll Dilemma

Once in possession of the scroll, the PCs must decide what to do with it. Malebranche has a meeting with his vassals in one week and intends to use the scroll to demonstrate that his power is intact and that he controls the only means capable of destroying the dome. The vassals are already plotting in secret: some suspect the dome is weaker than it appears.

Three possible choices:

- **Deliver the scroll to Malebranche:** The PCs go to the palace, Malebranche removes the collars and delivers the agreed 2500 gp. Malebranche strengthens his position, but the PCs remain indebted to an even more powerful tyrant.
- **Use the scroll to bring down the dome:** Malebranche is deposed, but chaos spreads throughout Orcastle. The PCs will have to face the consequences of an island at war.
- **Deliver the scroll to Ombrascura:** The collars are deactivated, but Ombrascura might betray them.

Means of Escape

The PCs have four options to get out of Orcastle:

1. **Griffons:** No longer available — the last one was used by Frankie in his previous escape, the others died in a battle between Highlanders.
2. **Teleportation at the Torre di Torth:** The portal in the tower's underground, activatable with the Coppa di Blackwood and the toast to Vecna. Teleports near Malebranche's palace.
3. **Malebranche's flying ships:** Reachable from the door to the southeast on the outer peninsula or from above the castro. They normally don't land, so stealing one is complicated.
4. **Bring down the walls with the scroll and escape by ship:** Ships moored in the harbor near the outer peninsula, in poor condition but functional. Usable only if the magical walls fall.

Malebranche's Palace

If the PCs manage to escape and decide to deliver the scroll, they must reach Malebranche's palace. There Malebranche removes the collar and delivers the agreed 2500 gp.

Collars Deactivated or Expired

If the PCs free themselves from the collars or after the seventh rest, 3d6 mercenaries in Malebranche's pay are parachuted onto the outer peninsula in search of the scroll. Ombrascura has contacts at court who can cancel the glyphs, but when he does, Malebranche will decide to attack in force — an attack that demonstrates his weakness to the vassals and is politically dangerous for him.

Rewards

- 2500 gp if the scroll is delivered to Malebranche (collar removal included)
 - Possible pact with Vecna (collar removal in exchange for an unspecified future mission)
 - The Coppa di Blackwood (functions as Dispel Magic, word: "Obloc Vecnal")
 - Alliances with the island's factions (Ruby, Emerald, Highlander) depending on choices made
-

Items

La Pergamena del Giudizio

The scroll's main power is to open the magical barrier blocking Orcastle. It contains three elements: the spell to bring down the walls, a message spell with the password "Zikle l'Illuminato" to send to Mesusu, and Malebranche's secret.

Activation: only a paladin, a character pure of heart, or Malebranche and his blood relatives can activate it. The secret phrase "The walls shall fall, the power shall end" must be spoken (known to Ombrascura). The scroll is protected by a powerful curse — Ombrascura knows the word but cannot use it, and is looking for an alternative way (his cleric Dispel Magic is not powerful enough).

Coppa di Blackwood

Artifact found at the top of the Torre di Torth, among dozens of other cups on the altar. Functions as a Dispel Magic of sufficient level to remove the explosive collars.

Activation word: "Obloc Vecnal" (Praise Vecna in Infernal). Detect Magic reveals only that it is abjuration. Arcana DC 15 to understand its function.

Book "Il mistero della torre di Torth"

In Miranda Emerald's possession. Confirms the presence of a passage in the well beneath the tower, to be opened with a ritual performed at the top of the tower near the altar. Contains no other details. The legend, with fewer details, is known to everyone on the island.

Explosive Collars

Control and coercion devices designed to eliminate the wearers in case of disobedience or failure. The glyphs are linked to the collars and placed in Malebranche's palace (modified version of Glyph of Warding).

Explosion: Radius 3m / 10ft / 2sq, 10d8 fire damage + 5d6 bludgeoning damage (average damage 45, maximum 110). Dexterity saving throw DC 16 to halve. On failure, the wearer is knocked prone and stunned for 1 round.

Activation: Attempted removal without the code, exceeding the time limit (seventh long rest), or remote activation by the jailer.

Deactivation: Intelligence (Arcana) or Dexterity (Thieves' Tools) DC 20. A natural 1 causes the collar to explode immediately (homebrew rule: in 5e a natural 1 is not an automatic failure on ability checks, but here it is for narrative tension). Dispel Magic of 5th level or higher works, or the deactivation command from whoever activated it.

Ways to remove the collars:

1. Dispel Magic — the PCs probably don't have the necessary power
 2. The Coppa di Blackwood — is actually a Dispel Magic powerful enough
 3. The pact with Vecna — the avatar offers removal in exchange for a future mission
 4. Ombrascura's contacts at court can cancel the glyphs, but this triggers Malebranche's attack
-

Milestone

Level reached: 9 **Trigger:** escape from Orcastle (by any means) and resolution of the scroll/collar situation.

DM Notes

This is a sandbox adventure: the PCs can explore the four zones in any order. The collar timer (7 long rests) creates urgency but should not stifle exploration — the PCs have enough time to visit all zones if they don't waste days.

Frankie Partenope is the narrative guide. He starts talking only once on the island and knows crucial information: the two openings in the dome (above the castro, guarded; outer peninsula, opens every two weeks — too late), the legend of the Torre di Torth as a third escape route, and the fact that the griffons are no longer there. Frankie hates Malebranche because he was unjustly imprisoned.

Ombrascura is the true engine of the intrigue. He hides in the East as Elemir Strunz, a follower of Axel. His original plan — enter Orcastle with the scroll, free everyone, and end Malebranche's power — is not working because he cannot activate the scroll. He knows the legend of the tower and the existence of Miranda's book, but does not know if the contents are truthful.

The factions are in an unstable equilibrium. The PCs can ally with one or more factions, but every alliance has a price (bringing an enemy alive or dead, winning a duel). The insignia are important for moving between zones.

The island map has five key points: A1 (the castro, scroll in the underground), A2 (Torre di Torth, teleportation in the underground), A3 (main entrance to the castro, guarded), A4 (griffon stables, now empty), A5 (outer peninsula to the southeast, rare landing point for ships).

Key characters and reference stats:

character	role	stats
Frankie Partenope	specialist, barbarian lv5	HP 40, AC 17, war axe +6 (1d10+4)
Lord Cedric Malebranche	the client, necromancer wizard	stats: archmage
Malachias Ombrascura (Elemir Strunz)	the scroll thief, dragonborn cleric	stats: priest
Mesusu Merconè	Airborne captain, dwarf	stats: guard
Kurzum	broker, dwarf	stats: veteran
Axel Ruby	Ruby leader, former vassal	stats: thug
Miranda Emerald	Emerald leader, mage	stats: 2nd level mage
Lord Kreig Highlander	castro leader, Malebranche's cousin	stats: knight
Vecna	deity (avatar)	does not fight, cannot be hit
Zikle l'Illuminato	scroll creator (dead)	goblin wizard, killed by Malebranche

△ Auto-translated from Italian. The Italian version is the source of truth.

Tower of Torth — DM Map

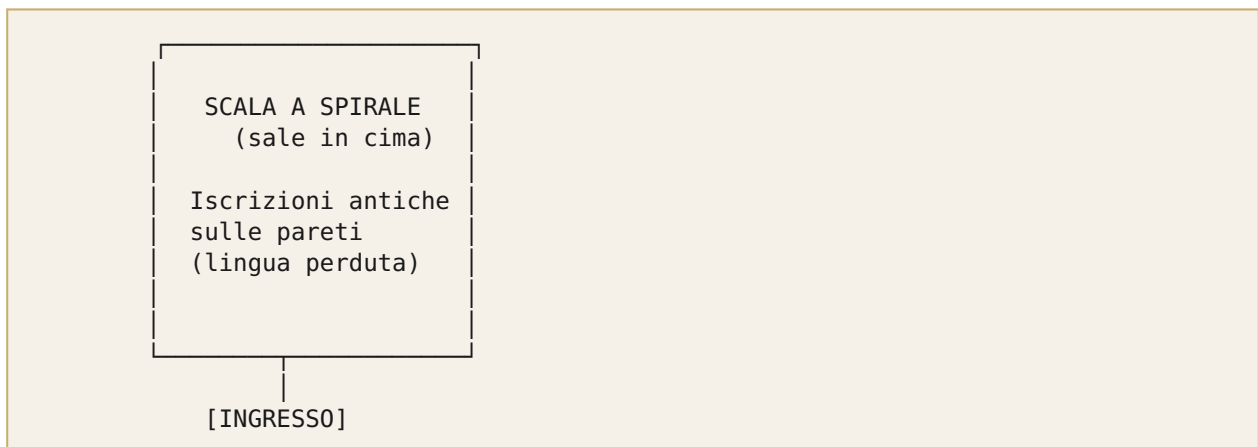
Overview

Ancient temple dedicated to Vecna, built by the priest Ablunth Torth as a monument to dark power. Located in the northern area of the island of Orcastle, beyond the rocky plain infested by cultists and devils. The tower is made of black stone, apparently uninhabited, with a spiral of steep stairs. The air is thick with magical energy and the walls bear inscriptions in a lost language.

The structure has three levels: entrance/hall on the ground floor, altar room at the top, and underground dungeon accessible through a well that opens with a ritual.

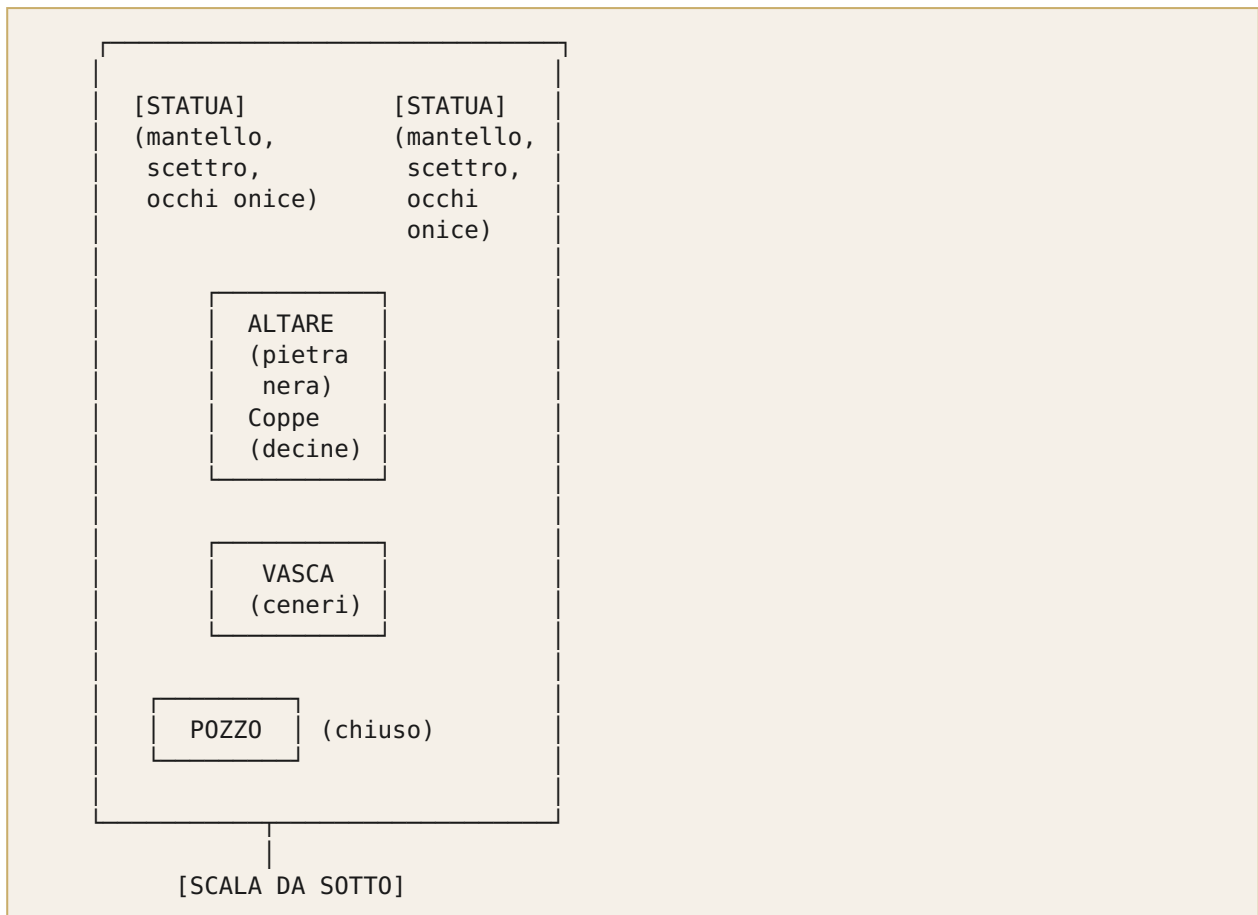
Layout

Level 1 — Entrance and Hall



- **Walls:** Inscriptions in a lost language. Decipherable with Comprehend Languages or Arcana DC 15. Text: "Honor to Vecna, Vecna who opens the doors; I raise the chalice and toast to you."
- **Spiral staircase:** Steep stairs leading to the room at the top of the tower.
- **Appearance:** Black stone, air thick with magical energy.

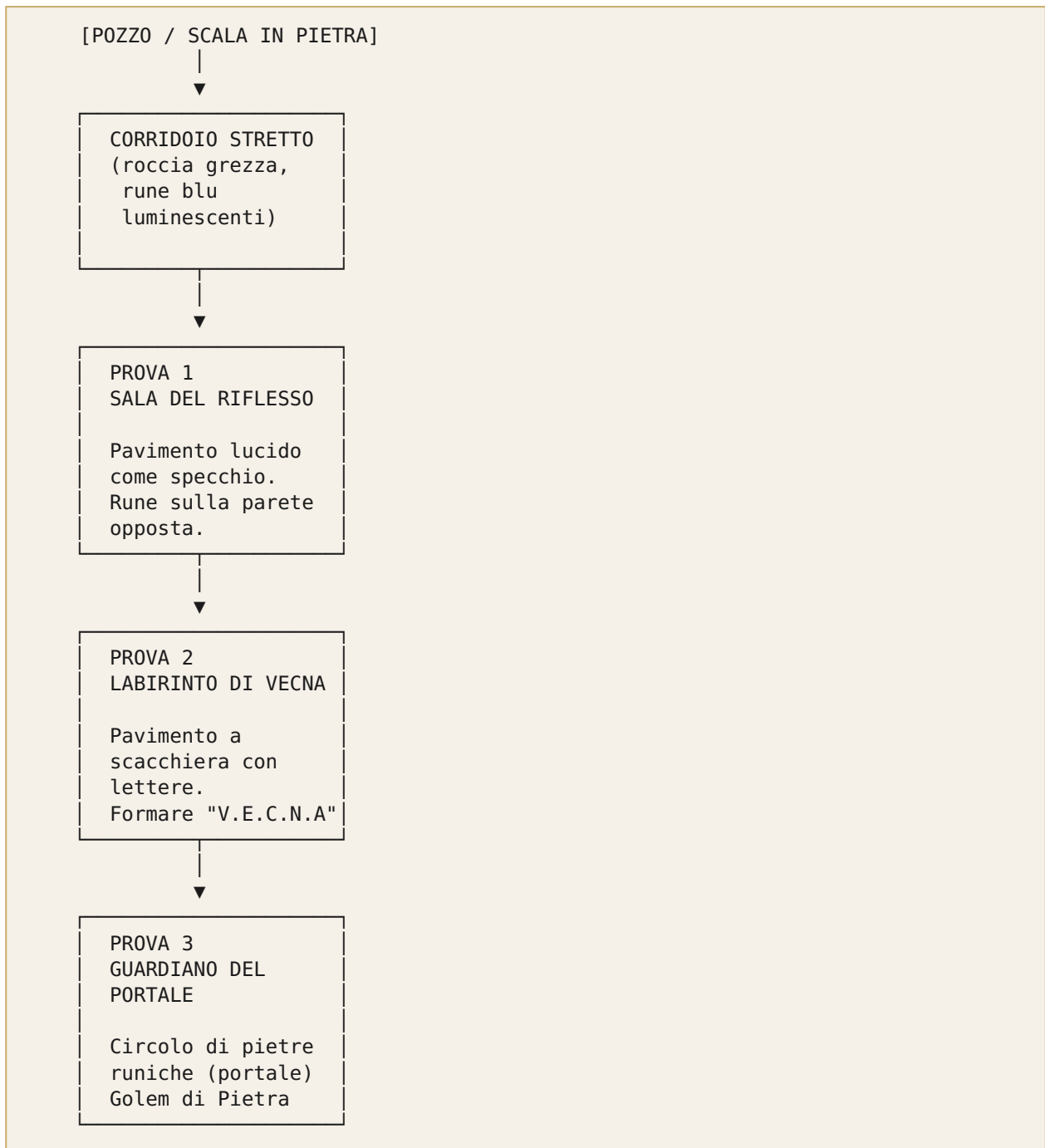
Level 2 — Altar Room (top of the tower)



- **Two statues:** Figures wrapped in cloaks wielding scepters, eyes inlaid with onyx. On either side of the altar.
- **Black stone altar:** Dozens of cups on top. Among them hides the **Coppa di Blackwood**.
- **Stone basin:** Filled with ashes. In front of the altar.
- **Well:** Closed. Opens only by completing the ritual (see DM Notes).
- **Air:** Cold and vibrating with ancient power.

Key contents: - **Coppa di Blackwood** — Hidden among the other cups on the altar. Inscription in Common: “Dark is the night in the heart of the righteous.” Picking it up and reading the inscription causes Vecna to appear. - **Ritual inscription:** “Offer your blood, reveal a secret, and finally burn, my child, burn what has already been burned.” - **Murals:** Depicts red drops, a fire, a shadow descending a staircase emerging from an open well.

Level 3 — Underground Dungeon (below the well)



Trial 1 — Hall of Reflection: - Floor polished like a mirror. - The PCs' doubles emerge from the floor and attack. - Runes on the opposite wall with the phrase: "The shadow is nothing without the light, the shadow has the power you give it." - Insight or Arcana DC 15 to understand that ignoring the doubles is the solution. - The doubles use only basic attacks and cantrips, same HP/AC as the PCs, vulnerable to psychic damage, do not heal.

Trial 2 — Labyrinth of Vecna: - Checkerboard floor with letters on each tile. - Walk on the correct letters to spell “V.E.C.N.A.” - Wrong letter: poisoned dart, 2d4+2 piercing damage to all (Dexterity saving throw DC 12 halves).

Trial 3 — Guardian of the Portal: - Final room with the Teleportation Portal (circle of runic stones). - **Stone Golem** (HP 178, AC 17, +10, 3d8+6 slam) guards the portal. - Combat or Deception/Persuasion DC 18 to convince it you are the new custodians. - Fresco on the wall: open portal and a cleric drinking from a cup.

The Teleportation Portal: - Requires the Coppa di Blackwood. - Arcana or History DC 15 to understand the rite. - Toasting with the cup in honor of Vecna activates the portal. - Teleports to the vicinity of Malebranche’s palace on the mainland.

DM Notes

Ritual to Open the Well (Level 2 → Level 3)

At least **2 out of 3 steps** must succeed:

1. **Offer blood** — A PC offers blood on the altar (1d6 necrotic damage). The blood is absorbed, the basin emits a red glow.
2. **Evoke the past** — Tell aloud a memory or promise. Persuasion or Religion DC 13. If they fail, the statues come to life and attack.
3. **Light the sacred flames** — A fire spell (Fireball, Burning Hands, or similar) on the ashes in the basin. The gems in the statues glow, a loud noise from the foundations.

Vecna’s Apparition (Level 2)

- Appears when the Coppa di Blackwood is picked up and the inscription is read.
- It is an avatar: cannot be hit and cannot hit.
- Proposes a pact: will remove the collars in exchange for a future mission (unspecified).
- If they accept, reveals that the cup functions as Dispel Magic. Magic word: “Obloc Vecnal” (Praise Vecna in Infernal).
- The PCs can also discover the function with Arcana DC 15. Detect Magic reveals only abjuration.

Doubles in the Hall of Reflection

Run as simplified copies: only basic attacks (main weapon) and cantrips, no spell slots or class features. Same HP and AC but no active magic items. Damage dealt by the doubles is psychic. Detect Magic reveals illusion. The shadows disappear after wounding at least three characters. The goal is the discovery that ignoring them is the solution.

Access to the Northern Area

Before reaching the tower, the PCs must cross the rocky plain to the north with three sequential encounters: 1. 4 cult fanatics (CR 2) — EASY 2. 2 bearded devils (CR 5) + 2 imps (CR 1) invisible — MEDIUM 3. 1 chain devil (CR 8) + surviving imps — HARD

The plain offers partial or total cover (1d4: 1-3 partial, 4 total).

△ Auto-translated from Italian. The Italian version is the source of truth.

Module 2: The Scepter of Tyr

Prelude — After Orcastle

△ This prelude should be adapted by the DM based on the players' choices in Module A. The details below assume the most common path (escape from the Torre di Torth), but there are many variants.

After escaping Orcastle — through the portal of the Torre di Torth, with the scroll, or by other means — the PCs find themselves on the mainland. If they delivered the scroll to Malebranche, they received the 2500 gp and the collars were removed. If they escaped by other means, the collars were neutralized by the Coppa di Blackwood or the pact with Vecna.

In any case, Vecna has taken notice. Whether the PCs accepted his pact at the Torre di Torth or not, the God of Secrets has been watching them and considers them his instruments. In the nights following the escape, all PCs receive the same dream: Vecna speaking in the darkness, reminding them of the debt (if they accepted the pact) or threatening consequences (if they did not).

The PCs reach Baldur's Gate — the largest and safest city on the Sword Coast — to rest, resupply, and decide their next step. It is here that Vecna's dream becomes an explicit order.

Description

A mission has been entrusted to you — not by choice, but by necessity. Vecna, the God of Secrets who holds you in his grip, demands that you recover Lo Scettro di Tyr, an ancient crystal relic said to have been wielded by the god of justice himself. The journey will take you from Baldur's Gate to the ruins of the Temple of Lumina, through frozen mountains and forgotten dangers. But the Scepter is cursed: whoever possesses it without being pure of heart slowly loses their soul, transforming into an undead servant. And the mere fact of having accepted Vecna's mission has already made you impure.

The characters are tasked by Vecna with recovering Lo Scettro di Tyr from the Temple of Lumina, a place lost for millennia in the mountains east of Baldur's Gate. The Scepter is an ancient crystal artifact that grants immense power, but is cursed: whoever uses it without being pure loses their soul and becomes an undead servant. Only the pure can withstand its power.

Vecna wants the Scepter to amplify his dark power and transform anyone who opposes him into undead. The Custodi dell'Equilibrio, an order devoted to Tyr led by Sir Alaric il Giusto, seek the same relic — but Alaric hides personal ambitions of absolute power. The protagonists find themselves potentially on the side of evil, and their choices will determine their fate.

The module covers the entire narrative arc: the departure from Baldur's Gate, the journey through the mountains, the exploration of the Temple of Lumina dungeon, the passage into the ethereal plane of Erythale, and the final confrontation with Alaric.

Objective

Recover Lo Scettro di Tyr from the Temple of Lumina and decide its fate: deliver it to Vecna, use it against him, destroy it, or return it to Tyr.

Internal Locations

Part 1 — Baldur's Gate

The mission begins in Baldur's Gate. The group meets in a tavern to discuss the dream Vecna sent to everyone (see Prelude). Vecna reminds them of the debt they owe and that his wrath will fall upon them if they do not seek the Scepter — but immeasurable rewards await them if they accomplish the task. He provides a cryptic clue:

"In the place where the scepter fell and justice was blinded, seek the key that opens the path to the power that is rightfully yours."

The clue refers to the ruins of the Temple of Lumina, the place where the Scepter was lost centuries ago during the Fall of the Temple. It is said the temple is haunted by spirits and guards forgotten secrets.

If the characters choose to ignore Vecna's request, sinister events begin to occur signaling the growing wrath of the God of Secrets. Roll 1d6 every long rest:

d6	Effect
1	Muscle stiffness — disadvantage on Dexterity checks (temporary, resolves after a long rest)
2	Initiative –2 (temporary, resolves after a long rest)
3	One level of exhaustion (cumulative, permanent)
4	A nightmare with Vecna promising death
5	Headache — disadvantage on History and Religion checks (temporary, resolves after a long rest)
6	Fleeting apparition of Vecna cursing them

The Tavern

In Baldur’s Gate everyone knows who Tyr is and vaguely knows that an object connected to him was lost in a temple. If questioned directly, the locals suggest going to the temple of Tyr or the library. If the PCs enter a tavern, roll 1d4: on a result of 1, a bard performs a ballad titled “The Fall of Lumina”, which tells the story of the glorious temple dedicated to Tyr and its mysterious disappearance. In the central square, a notice announces a lecture given by Master Elrin on the history of lost temples, including Lumina, at the library.

The Temple of Tyr in Baldur’s Gate

In the temple, depicted like a comic strip, are Tyr holding a scepter and the fall of the temple. Sir Alaric, a member of the Custodi dell’Equilibrio, originally from the Ten Towns and later relocated to Baldur’s Gate, can be encountered here or in front of the poster for Master Elrin’s lecture.

Alaric is more than willing to describe who he is and what he is doing if he believes the PCs are scholars of religion or ancient matters. If they mention Vecna he becomes grim; if they declare they work for the evil god he becomes hostile and will not help them. He says he is investigating suspicious activities linked to Vecna, who apparently wants to reclaim the Scepter. If they mention Vecna they must make a Deception check (DC 12) or be convincing in their roleplay to demonstrate they are not linked to Vecna.

If they manage to earn Alaric’s trust, they could obtain additional clues. Alaric knows that Vecna is searching for the Scepter and that the Custodi are worried he might reach the Temple of Lumina. He plans to go to the temple himself, but under no circumstances does he want to join the PCs. He will arrive at the Temple of Lumina a few hours after them. If the PCs attacked the Custodi at the Valle del Giudizio, Alaric will be alarmed and hostile.

The Library of Baldur's Gate

Master Elrin is an elderly scholar of theological topics. If the PCs manage to win him over, he will find the book they seek for them. Otherwise they can find it:

- By staying in the library for more than 4 hours
- By making an Investigation check (DC 19)
- By asking the librarian after getting a library card (free, they don't ask questions about the name given)

The library has among its books "Chronicles of the Fall of Lumina", a theology book written in Common, which tells the story of the Scepter and its curse. The book contains crucial details about the exact location of the temple — namely a map — about the ancient rituals and the legends regarding Lo Scettro di Tyr.

Part 2 — The Journey to the Temple of Lumina

The route follows the trade road eastward, into the interior of the continent. The journey is about 10 days on foot. The map found in the library indicates the stages, one day's walk apart from each other. If the PCs travel by cart it takes half the time. A character familiar with life in Baldur's Gate will find one easily. They cannot walk or ride horses for more than 10 hours a day, after which they must stop to rest.

The stages of the journey:

1. **Baldur's Gate** — Plains near the sea.
2. **Village of Greenest** — Plains east of Baldur's Gate. No monsters, they can resupply. The locals know the legend of the Scepter in broad strokes.
3. **Forest of Lost Shadows** — Wooded hills. Two owlbears (MM p. 250) and a harpy (MM p. 20) looking for shiny objects. The owlbears walk through the forest to the right of the PCs heading in the opposite direction (east to west); the harpy is flying above their heads. The owlbears attack only as a reaction; the harpy tries to charm them or attacks only if she sees shiny objects.
4. **Valle del Giudizio** — Mountain pass (see below). From here on it is not possible to continue by cart.
5. **Village of Silenza** — Abandoned mountain village (see below).
6. **Rocca Bianca** — Full mountain (see below).
7. **Monti di Eterna Neve** — 3-day climb (see below).
8. **Piana delle Lacrime** — Plateau (see below).
9. **Ruins of the Temple of Lumina** — Final stage.

Valle del Giudizio — The Assault of the Custodi dell'Equilibrio

In a narrow mountain gorge called the Valle del Giudizio, the PCs encounter a patrol of paladins of Tyr led by an officer. The Custodi believe — and they are not entirely wrong — that the PCs are agents of Vecna intent on stealing the Scepter. The paladins block the passage and interrogate the characters about their intentions. With a Deception check (DC 16) they can pass the checkpoint without fighting.

Encounter Difficulty: DEADLY (4 veterans CR 3 + 1 priest CR 2 = ~11000 XP adjusted for 4-5 PCs lv9). These are sacred warriors of Tyr, not cultists — they fight with discipline and conviction.

name	#	HP	AC	attack	notes
Veteran (paladin of Tyr)	4	58	17	+5, 2d8+3 greatsword	MM p. 350 CR 3. Disciplined, fight in formation
Priest (Custodi officer)	1	27	13	+4, 1d6+1 mace + spells	MM p. 348 CR 2. Cure Wounds, Shield of Faith, Spirit Guardians

The Custodi reveal details about Vecna's plans and the Scepter's curse if questioned or if the encounter is resolved amicably. It is clear that the Custodi dell'Equilibrio are determined to stop anyone seeking the Scepter for nefarious purposes. If the PCs do not hide the bodies, Alaric will learn of their betrayal.

Village of Silenza

An abandoned mountain village. If the PCs search, they find ghosts. They have no intention of attacking them. If questioned they say:

"We were here thousands of years ago, during the battle for the Scepter. Tyr is great, Ormut the purest of us. He saved everyone by carrying the Scepter beyond the edge."

They are two priests of Tyr who died after fleeing the battle; they were on the loyalist side in the civil war that led to the destruction of Lumina. If questioned further, they recount that, having fled to this village months after the battle, they were reached by Vecna's forces who wanted to know where the Scepter was. The battle that followed also destroyed this village. After that they continue to repeat the above.

Rocca Bianca — Brother Thaddeus

In a mountain village, Rocca Bianca, Brother Thaddeus can be encountered, a monk and former disciple of Tyr. He still wears the insignia (a stylized severed hand) and maintains the faith. He left the order after discovering the true intentions of Alaric il Giusto.

He can be found in the tavern or the local temple. If he understands and approves of the PCs' intentions, he offers crucial information: he explains what the Scepter is and its relationship with the Temple of Lumina, reveals the hidden ambitions of Alaric il Giusto, and warns about Vecna's true intentions. He emphasizes the danger of the Scepter's curse for those who are not pure of heart. If the characters do not trust him, they can make an Insight check (DC 12) to evaluate Thaddeus's sincerity.

Anyone else they meet at Rocca Bianca warns them of the dangers (cold, climbing, monsters) they will find on the road. They can find, for a price, heavy clothing, ice axes, and whatever is needed for climbing.

Monti di Eterna Neve — The Long Climb

Before you rises an imposing mountain range. This stretch of road will be very difficult and climbing will be necessary.

The climb lasts 3 days. The dangers are: intense cold and fatigue (especially at night), risk of falls, and monsters at the midpoint.

Cold: Each character must make a Constitution saving throw every 8 hours to resist the cold. On failure they suffer one level of exhaustion. If the characters prepare with winter clothing, the DCs decrease.

Condition	Normal DC	DC with winter clothing
Daytime, moving	12	8
Daytime, stationary	14	10
Nighttime	16	12

Climbing fatigue: Athletics check (DC 14) at the end of each day of travel. On failure, one level of exhaustion.

Falls: Once per day a random character must make a Dexterity saving throw (DC 13). On failure they slip. The next character must make an Athletics check (DC 14) to grab them. If no one stops them and they are roped together: 2d6 falling damage. If they are not roped together: 1d6 falling damage, then a new attempt to grab hold; on failure another 1d6 damage, and so on up to 4 times. In any case, they remain stuck in a dangerous position and require an Athletics check (DC 12) to climb back up.

Second Day — Yeti Cave: The PCs reach a plateau with a cave. If explored, or during the night, they are attacked by 3 hungry Yeti.

Encounter Difficulty: MEDIUM (1 Abominable Yeti CR 9 + 2 Yeti CR 3 = ~9600 XP adjusted for 4-5 PCs lv9)

name	#	HP	AC	attack	notes
Abominable Yeti	1	137	12	+7, 2d6+4 claw + cold breath	MM p. 306 CR 9. Pack leader, retreats below 35 HP
Yeti	2	51	12	+6, 1d6+4 claw (×2)	MM p. 306 CR 3. Retreat if the leader flees

Each of the three Yeti has a visible magical amulet around its neck that grants Cold Resistance. It can be taken with a Sleight of Hand or Dexterity check (DC 15), or if the Yeti is defeated.

Piana delle Lacrime — The Threshold

After three days of travel you reach the Piana delle Lacrime. A vast plateau shrouded in silvery mist, strewn with fragments of columns, broken statues, and remains of ancient buildings. The place exudes an aura of melancholy, as if it bore the weight of past tragedies.

The first one or two characters in line must make a Perception check (DC 13) to spot hidden crevasses along the path. On failure: fall into the crevasse, 3d6 falling damage (9m / 30ft / 6sq) and Athletics check (DC 15) to climb out.

Immediately after, the PCs are attacked by a **Roc** (MM p. 260) that has nested on the plateau and considers the place its territory. The raptor is old and wounded — it has reduced HP compared to standard. It attacks from above, attempting to grab the most vulnerable characters and lift them into the air. It retreats if it drops below 1/4 of its HP.

Encounter Difficulty: HARD (4-5 PCs lv9)

name	#	HP	AC	attack	notes
Roc (old, wounded)	1	150 (of 248)	15	+13, 4d8+9 talons / 4d6+9 beak	MM p. 260. Retreats below 38 HP. Can grapple (DC 19 Athletics to escape)

Treasure in the Roc's nest: 1d4 Potions of Resistance, a Longsword +1, jewels and coins (total value: 5000 gp).

Among the ruins, the characters find an inscription carved on a stone slab half-covered by snow. The runes are in an ancient language, similar to Elvish but with obvious differences. With a History or Religion check (DC 15) they manage to decipher the text. Master Elrin's book gives +5 to the roll.

"Beyond the edge Ormut carried them, hidden forever, only Tyr and Ormut know the secret. The word of the pure holds the power you seek. Use it wisely."

Ormut was a legendary devotee of Tyr, a guardian tasked with protecting the Scepter after the fall of Lumina. Fearing that the Scepter's power could be corrupted, Ormut used a powerful magic gifted by Tyr to hide it beyond the material plane. The inscription suggests that Ormut created a breach to another plane of existence — the Kingdom of Erythale — and that only those with a pure heart and just intentions can access it.

Part 3 — The Temple of Lumina (dungeon)

The plateau stretches for kilometers. In the distance you can make out the remains of an ancient city clearly in ruins. Inexplicably, the cold that has been intense throughout the journey seems to have subsided, as if an ancient magic still had effect on these places.

Continuing through the ruins, you come upon an enormous semi-intact structure, clearly recognizable as a temple dedicated to Tyr. The columns that once supported a majestic portico lie broken, but everywhere you can see the symbols of the stylized severed hand, the unmistakable emblem of the god of justice.

At the entrance to the temple, the figure of Tyr appears before the PCs and says:

"You have come this far seeking the Scepter, but none of you is worthy. Your pact with Vecna has corrupted you, staining your soul. Until you prove yourselves pure, the power you seek will lead you only to ruin. The Scepter will never reveal itself to impure hearts, nor will its power be yours without a price."

“There is a way, but it will be a path of suffering and sacrifice. Only by facing the trials I set before you can you hope to purify your spirits and free yourselves from Vecna’s shadow.”

“Remember: pure is the magnanimous one who can forgive the defeated, the one who devotes themselves to me renouncing evil and promising future good, and the one who finally sacrifices something for the good of all.”

The dungeon has 12 rooms. The characters must prove their purity to obtain Tyr’s blessing and access Erythale.

Room 1 — Entrance

A staircase descending downward. Three openings to the east, west, and north. The room is completely empty: cracks on the walls, dust, and ruins.

Room 2 — Passage

Completely empty. Cracks on the walls, dust, and ruins.

Room 3 — The Colonnade

Columns with depictions of Tyr and inscriptions with theological passages from the god’s writings. With an Investigation check (DC 12) the PCs find a depiction of the stone golem from Room 4 with the inscription in ancient Elvish “The Guardian of Lumina” or “The Guardian of Tyr”.

Room 4 — The Guardian of Lumina (Room of Magnanimity)

An enormous fresco on the west wall depicts the Temple of Tyr with disciples entering and exiting. The images of the disciples are slightly luminous — without needing checks, the characters notice this. If they investigate, they perceive a faint evocation magic emanating from the fresco. They can see the inscription in ancient Elvish “The Guardian of Lumina/Tyr”, which is the golem’s title and duty.

A stone golem is crouched in the middle of the room. It attacks anyone who enters. The golem is clearly wounded. It was originally a sacred guardian of the temple, but is now pervaded by Vecna’s dark influence. Full stat block: see [characters/markdown/MON_GuardianoLumina.md](#).

Encounter Difficulty: MEDIUM (4-5 PCs lv9) — the golem has only 50 HP of the original 178.

During combat, the characters can notice with Insight (DC 12) that the monster fights desperately, trapped in a fate it cannot control. Manifestations of luminous energy begin to emerge from the fresco: lights that take the form of ethereal human figures, whispering broken phrases. With Perception (DC 10) fragments can be heard: “Help... purify... forgiveness...”

The golem can be freed from corruption with Dispel Magic (DC 14, 4th-level spell) or if rendered unconscious and allowed to reawaken. Once free, the golem is disoriented, asks who they are and where it is, then after a few moments heads toward the temple entrance to resume its service.

Only those who spare or save the golem (a single character) receive Tyr’s blessing.

Golem stat block: see Enemies section.

Room 5

In the lower left a locked chest, pickable at DC 12. Contains 1d20 gold pieces and a scroll of Dispel Magic. In the upper right a statue of Tyr less destroyed than the others, with the usual theological inscription.

Room 6 — Bat Room

Similar to Room 3, but infested by a swarm of bats that attack anyone who enters. If disturbed by a bright light, fire, or if they take at least 4 points of damage, they flee the room.

Room 7 — The Guardian Defends the Temple

A fresco entirely similar to the one in Room 4, but in which the guardian fights enemies who are attacking the temple.

Room 8 — Room of Blessing

There is a well and other symbols of Tyr. A fresco shows disciples immersing themselves in the font at the center of the room. If the PCs touch the water, Tyr appears and asks two questions:

“Who is evil?”

The PCs can answer “Vecna” or something appropriate.

“Do you promise to defend the good? Promise three times!”

They must answer “I promise, I promise, I promise.” If they do not, Tyr insists.

Tyr’s blessing falls upon the PCs if they curse the name of Vecna and promise to save three innocents while bathing in the font. A maximum of two adventurers can perform the rite. (DM Note: potential hook for the next adventure — the three good deeds promised.)

Room 9 — The Just Shadows

At the center of the room is a light source illuminating a stone table surrounded by empty chairs, arranged as if for a meeting. On the walls, shadows move, even though no figures are present.

When the characters approach the table, the shadows solidify taking the form of humanoid figures dressed as judges and priests of Tyr. The figures seem to judge the characters with their empty eyes, but do not speak. On the surface of the table, verses are carved:

*“Only the pure can walk in the light, but even the shadow of justice can be just.
Only when you understand both, shall the path be revealed.”*

If Ormut’s voice is with the PCs (they have already received the blessing), a Medallion of Justice appears on the table — a magic item that grants advantage on saving throws against fear or necrotic spells for 24 hours.

If instead they attempt to attack the shadows, they transform into 6 specters that attack screaming “Heretics!” and “Impure ones, begone!”

Encounter Difficulty: HARD (3 specters CR 1 + 2 wraiths CR 5 = ~8400 XP adjusted for 4-5 PCs lv9). Only if the PCs attack the shadows.

name	#	HP	AC	attack	notes
Wraith	2	67	13	+6, 4d8+3 necrotic	MM p. 302 CR 5. Lead the specters
Specter	3	22	12	+4, 3d6 necrotic	MM p. 279 CR 1

Room 10

No treasure or enemies. A fresco depicts the stone giant defending the temple and the Scepter bearer from enemies.

Room 12 – Room of Sacrifice (passage to Erythale)

At the end of a staircase that terminates against a wall, there is the passage to Erythale. A magical flame burns in the middle of the room. On the wall at the end of the staircase there is an inscription: “A’ lammen en’ iand” — meaning “Beyond the threshold” in Elvish (A’ = “toward/beyond”, Lammen = “threshold/door”, En’ = “of/the”, Iand = “boundary/beyond”).

Ormut’s voice guides the PCs toward the staircase — but only if they have already received Tyr’s blessing (Room 4, 8, or through the sacrifice in the flame below). If they do not have the blessing, they must first perform the sacrifice in the flame to obtain Ormut’s voice and be able to cross the threshold.

Ormut explains that to pass through the wall at the end of the staircase they will need to have faith in Tyr: they must run through it, without being afraid of crashing. If investigated, the wall appears solid; they pass only if they enter at a run. An abjuration and illusion magical aura covers the wall.

If the PCs destroy in the flame any object that has real value to them (magic items, mementos of loved ones, a large amount of gold coins), they receive Tyr’s blessing. The DM must judge whether they are losing something of real value to the character. Everyone can perform this rite.

If they are not blessed by Tyr they cannot cross the threshold. They can detect the opening with Detect Magic (abjuration).

Those who receive Tyr’s blessing obtain the Blessing of Justice: - Advantage on saving throws against fear or necrotic effects for 24 hours. - An invisible voice (which will reveal itself to be Ormut, if asked) guides them toward Erythale.

Part 4 – Erythale, Beyond the Threshold

Beyond the threshold opens Erythale, an ethereal realm of light and crystal. The sky shines like a perpetual dawn and the transparent ground reflects every thought and emotion of the characters.

The Luminous Guardians are beings 3m / 10ft / 2sq tall made of pure light with translucent wings, similar to angels. They serve exclusively Tyr and have an innate sense of purity of soul. They communicate telepathically. They defend the Scepter because it represents the greatest symbol of justice and order in the multiverse. Anyone who is not pure, according to Tyr’s criteria, is seen as a threat.

The Guardians are friendly and take the PCs to the Crystal Sanctuary where the Scepter is kept. They will hand over the Scepter after being convinced of the PCs' good intentions and the necessity of doing so. No particular mechanics: they just need to be minimally convincing and get help from Ormut.

The Guardians explain what the PCs probably already know: the city of Lumina fell due to the betrayal of one of its priests, corrupted by Vecna's promises, who — like Alaric — had promised peace on earth through the Scepter's power and his command. Tyr himself commanded Ormut to hide the Scepter to prevent its misuse.

The PCs will have to decide who will be the Scepter's bearer. The bearer must swear on their life not to surrender it to others, to defend it, and to follow Tyr's instructions regarding its fate. They are warned that it is a great honor but also a great burden.

Bearer's Curse: If the bearer violates the pact, after unspeakable pain they fall unconscious and must make death saving throws with no possibility of being healed. If they survive, they will permanently have disadvantage on attack rolls. Only Tyr can remove the curse.

Lo Scettro di Tyr — Magical Properties

A divine weapon that channels justice and purity, cursed for those who are unworthy.

- **Sacred Resurrection** — The Scepter can bring back to life a recently deceased creature, provided its spirit is willing to return and the body is not completely destroyed. Functions as the Resurrection spell. Can be used only once. The Scepter judges the purity of the soul: a corrupted soul cannot be brought back to life.
- **Empowerment of Justice** — The bearer gains a sacred aura. All allies within 30ft / 9m / 6sq receive: +2 to attack rolls, resistance to necrotic and psychic damage, advantage on saving throws against fear effects.
- **Shield of Purity** — Activatable as a bonus action. Creates a force field around the bearer and two allies within 30ft / 9m / 6sq. Reduces all damage taken by half for 3 turns. Once per day.
- **Sentence of Tyr** — The bearer can invoke divine judgment on an enemy creature, forcing it to reveal its true intentions. The creature must make a Charisma saving throw (DC 18). On failure, it is paralyzed for 1 minute, unable to lie or hide its true nature. Once per day.

Part 5 — The Return to the Temple: The Final Battle

Exiting Room 1 by taking the staircase upward, the PCs find arrayed before them 15 veterans and Alaric il Giusto. Alaric demands they hand over the Scepter. The avatars of Tyr and Vecna appear silently, watching without intervening in the battle.

Vecna says: “Remember your promise.” And adds: “Give the Scepter to Alaric.”

DM Note: Vecna is lying. He does not want Alaric to keep the Scepter — he knows Alaric is corruptible and that the Scepter will consume him, making him a puppet. Vecna intends to recover the Scepter from Alaric at a later time, when he will be too weak to resist. If the PCs give it to him, Vecna wins in the long term.

Tyr says: “Remember your promise. Use it for good, or destroy it.”

The PCs can fight. If they manage to make Alaric confess his dark plans for power (using the Sentence of Tyr or through roleplay), the veterans turn against him.

If the golem from Room 4 was not defeated earlier, it stands beside the PCs at the entrance and fights on their side.

Enemies

Final Battle — Alaric and the Veterans

Encounter Difficulty: DEADLY (4-5 PCs lv9)

name	#	HP	AC	attack	notes
Veteran	15	58	17	+5, 2d8+3 greatsword	MM p. 350. Turn against Alaric if he confesses
Alaric il Giusto	1	90	15	see below	Mage variant (MM p. 348)
Guardian of Lumina	1	50	17	+8, 3d8+6 punch	Only if not defeated before. Fights alongside the PCs

Full stat block: see `characters/markdown/NPC_SirAlaric.md`.

Full stat block: see `characters/markdown/MON_GuardianoLumina.md`.

Key Clues

- **Vecna’s clue** in the tavern points to the Temple of Lumina.
- **The book “Chronicles of the Fall of Lumina”** in the library of Baldur’s Gate contains the temple map and the story of the Scepter.

- **Sir Alaric** at the temple of Tyr reveals that Vecna seeks the Scepter and that the Custodi want to prevent it.
- **The ghosts of Silenza** speak of Ormut who carried the Scepter “beyond the edge”.
- **Brother Thaddeus** at Rocca Bianca reveals Alaric’s true ambitions and warns about the curse.
- **The inscription at the Piana delle Lacrime** confirms that Ormut hid the Scepter in another plane and that “the word of the pure” is the key.
- **Tyr’s words** at the temple indicate the three paths of purity: magnanimity (forgiving the golem), devotion (the rite at the font), sacrifice (the flame in Room 12).

Finale

With the Scepter in hand, the characters must decide its fate:

1. **Deliver the Scepter to Alaric** — Vecna will no longer persecute them, but the bearer risks dying from the curse of the violated pact, and Tyr will become their enemy, slowly taking their soul.
2. **Use the Scepter to fight Vecna** — They must first defeat Alaric in the final battle. Vecna will be their mortal enemy forever.
3. **Destroy the Scepter** — The bearer can destroy it by finding a magical way to inflict 100 damage in a single blow. This information can be requested from the Luminous Guardians or from Tyr. This is one of the three good deeds required by Tyr to become pure.
4. **Return the Scepter to Tyr** — Hook for a future adventure. This is also one of the three good deeds.

Rewards

- **Piana delle Lacrime treasure:** 1d4 Potions of Resistance, Longsword +1, jewels and coins (5000 gp).
- **Room 5 dungeon treasure:** 1d20 gold pieces, scroll of Dispel Magic.
- **Medallion of Justice** (Room 9, if Ormut’s voice is with them): advantage on saving throws against fear or necrotic spells for 24 hours.
- **Cold Resistance Amulets** (up to 3, from the Yeti).
- **Lo Scettro di Tyr** — the main artifact of the adventure, with the properties described in Part 4.
- **Blessing of Justice** — advantage on saving throws against fear or necrotic effects for 24 hours (obtained in the dungeon).

Milestone

Level reached: 10 **Trigger:** recovery of Lo Scettro di Tyr from Erythale and resolution of the confrontation with Alaric.

DM Notes

Scalability: - Smaller party (3 PCs): reduce veterans in the final battle to 10, reduce Yeti to 2, remove 2 cultists at the Valle del Giudizio. - Larger party (6 PCs): increase veterans to 20, add one Yeti, increase Alaric's HP to 120.

Narrative pacing: The module alternates phases of exploration and roleplay (Baldur's Gate, Silenza, Rocca Bianca, Erythale) with phases of environmental challenge (the climb) and combat (Valle del Giudizio, Yeti, Roc, dungeon, final battle). The temple dungeon is more a path of moral trials than a traditional dungeon — the combats are avoidable or solvable through roleplay.

Alaric and the veterans: The final battle is classified DEADLY, but it is designed to be resolved even without direct combat. If the PCs use the Sentence of Tyr or convince Alaric to reveal his true intentions, the veterans revolt. The DM should make this possibility clear through the clues from Brother Thaddeus and the Luminous Guardians.

Plan B — if roleplay fails: If the PCs cannot make Alaric confess and combat begins, the veterans are not fanatics — they are loyal soldiers but not suicidal. When Alaric drops below half HP (45), his Aura of Corruption wavers and the nearest veterans (1d6) hesitate and stop fighting for 1 round. If the PCs seize the opportunity to accuse Alaric aloud (Persuasion DC 14, with advantage if they have evidence from Thaddeus), the hesitating veterans revolt. The rest follow within 2 rounds. Without this intervention, the combat is an almost certain TPK.

The golem: If the PCs spare it in Room 4, the golem fights on their side in the final battle. It is a powerful but fragile ally (50 HP). If they defeated it, it is not present in the final battle.

The blessings: There are three ways to obtain Tyr's blessing: saving the golem (one PC only), the rite at the font in Room 8 (maximum two PCs), the sacrifice in the flame in Room 12 (everyone). Without at least one blessing, the PCs cannot cross the threshold to Erythale.

Vecna and punishment: If the PCs ignore the mission, the d6 table of sinister effects makes life progressively harder. The exhaustion level on result 3 is cumulative and permanent — use it sparingly.

Future hooks: The three good deeds promised to Tyr during the rite in Room 8 are an explicit hook for subsequent adventures. The destruction or return of the Scepter counts as one of these deeds.

The Lore

The Fall of the Temple of Lumina: Lo Scettro di Tyr was lost during the Fall of the Temple of Lumina, a catastrophic event that occurred thousands of years ago. During an attack by a faction of priests suspected of being under Vecna's influence, the main temple dedicated to Tyr was besieged. In the chaos of battle, a young priest corrupted by Vecna's promises of power stole the Scepter and attempted to deliver it to Vecna. However, the traitor was stopped by Ormut, a spellcaster who teleported the artifact to an unknown location before dying at the hands of the traitors. Since then, the Scepter has remained hidden, its location lost in time.

The Custodi dell'Equilibrio: An order dedicated to maintaining the balance between good and evil in the world, embodying the principles of justice and impartiality promoted by Tyr. Historically tasked with protecting Lo Scettro di Tyr, the supreme symbol of divine justice.

Alaric's secrets: Behind his facade of righteousness, Alaric hides a desire for absolute power. He wants to use the Scepter not only to restore peace, but to establish a world order under his control. He has discovered ancient rituals that would allow him to harness the Scepter's power to ascend to a semi-divine state, replacing Tyr and reshaping the world according to his vision.

Vecna: He is not pure, so he cannot recover the Scepter himself — he discovered this over the years and therefore must send someone else.



LoScettroDiTyrGeoMap

△ Auto-translated from Italian. The Italian version is the source of truth.

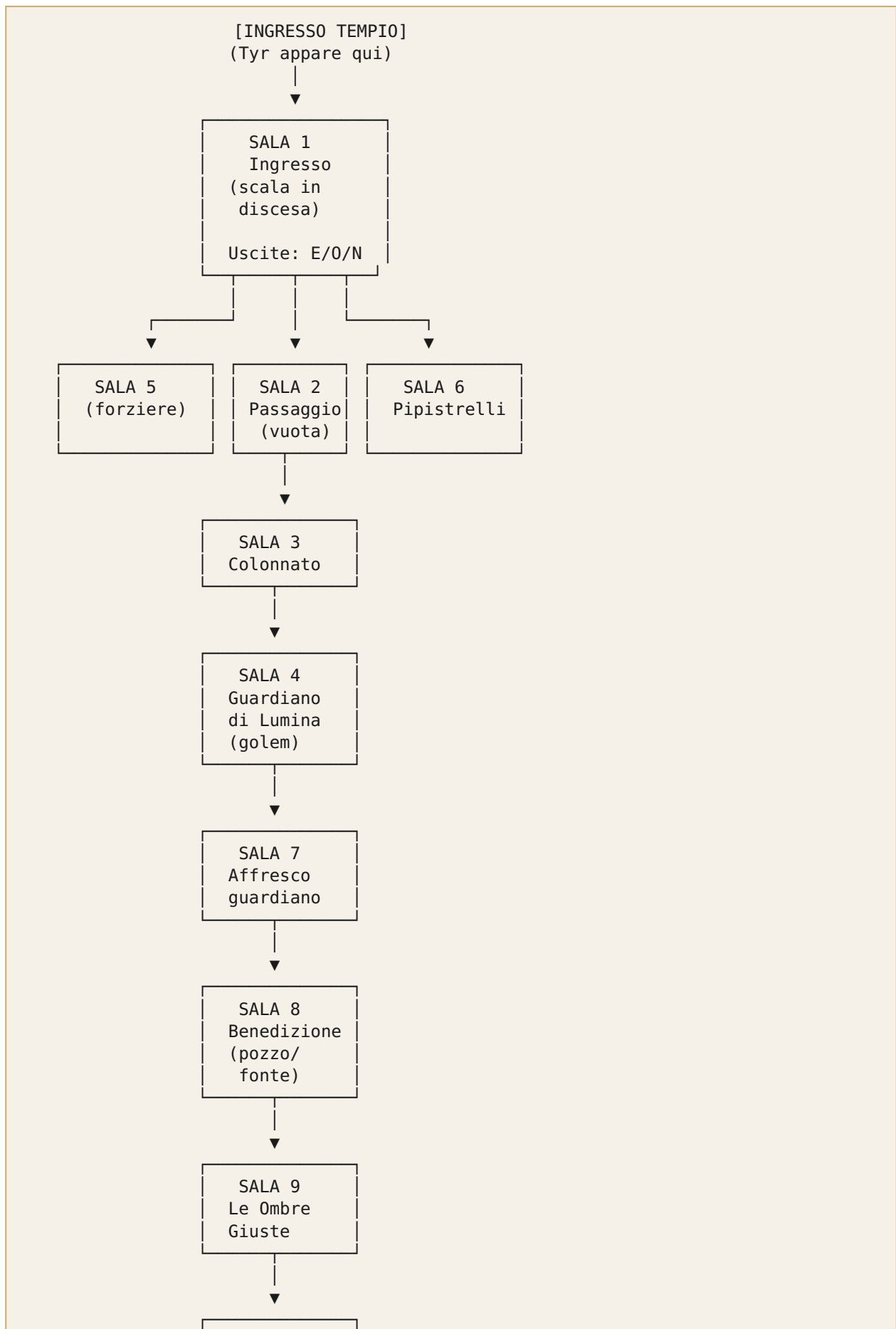
Temple of Lumina — DM Map

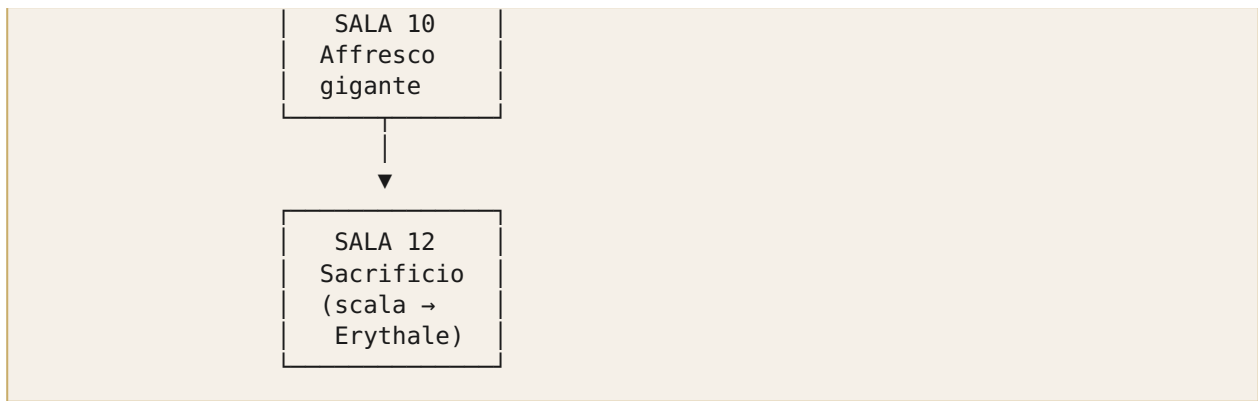
Overview

Ancient temple dedicated to Tyr, located at the end of the Piana delle Lacrime, on a mountain plateau east of Baldur's Gate (approximately 10 days of travel). The temple is semi-intact: broken columns, collapsed portico, but everywhere the symbols of Tyr's stylized severed hand can be seen. The intense cold of the journey inexplicably subsides near the temple, as if an ancient magic still had effect.

The dungeon has 12 rooms arranged across multiple levels (descending stairs). The PCs must prove their purity to obtain Tyr's blessing and access the ethereal plane of Erythale.

At the temple entrance, Tyr appears and warns the PCs that the pact with Vecna has corrupted them and that they must purify themselves.





Note: Room 11 is not described in the module. The layout proceeds from Room 10 directly to Room 12.

Room 1 — Entrance

- **Description:** Staircase descending downward. Three openings to the east, west, and north.
- **Contents:** Completely empty. Cracks on the walls, dust and ruins.
- **Exits:** East (→ Room 5), West (→ Room 6), North (→ Room 2).

Room 2 — Passage

- **Description:** Connecting room.
- **Contents:** Completely empty. Cracks on the walls, dust and ruins.
- **Exits:** South (→ Room 1), North (→ Room 3).

Room 3 — The Colonnade

- **Description:** Columns with depictions of Tyr and inscriptions with theological passages.
- **Contents:** Investigation DC 12 to find a depiction of the golem from Room 4 with an inscription in ancient Elvish: “The Guardian of Lumina” / “The Guardian of Tyr.”
- **Exits:** South (→ Room 2), North (→ Room 4).

Room 4 — The Guardian of Lumina (Room of Magnanimity)

- **Description:** Enormous fresco on the west wall: Temple of Tyr with luminous disciples. Inscription in ancient Elvish: “The Guardian of Lumina/Tyr.”
- **Contents:** **Stone Golem** crouched in the center. Attacks anyone who enters. Has only 50 HP of the original 178 (wounded). Pervaded by Vecna’s dark influence.
- **Hazards:** Combat with the golem (MEDIUM for 4-5 PCs lv9).
- **Secret:** Insight DC 12 to notice it fights desperately. Perception DC 10 to hear the figures in the fresco whispering “Help... purify... forgiveness...” Can be freed with

Dispel Magic DC 14 (4th level) or knocked unconscious and left to reawaken. Whoever spares/saves it receives **Tyr's blessing** (one PC only).

- **Exits:** South (→ Room 3), North (→ Room 7).

Room 5 — Chest

- **Description:** Side room accessible from the east of Room 1.
- **Contents:** Locked chest in the lower left (Thieves' Tools DC 12). Contains: 1d20 gold coins + scroll of Dispel Magic. Statue of Tyr in the upper right with a theological inscription.
- **Exits:** West (→ Room 1).

Room 6 — Bat Room

- **Description:** Similar to Room 3 (columns and inscriptions).
- **Contents:** Swarm of bats that attack anyone who enters. They flee if exposed to bright light, fire, or if they take at least 4 HP of damage.
- **Exits:** East (→ Room 1).

Room 7 — The Guardian Defends the Temple

- **Description:** Fresco similar to Room 4, but depicting the guardian fighting enemies attacking the temple.
- **Contents:** No enemies or treasure. Purely narrative element.
- **Exits:** South (→ Room 4), North (→ Room 8).

Room 8 — Room of the Blessing

- **Description:** Well/fountain at the center and symbols of Tyr. Fresco of disciples immersing themselves in the fountain.
- **Contents:** If the PCs touch the water, Tyr appears and asks two questions.
- **Secret:** Tyr asks "Who is evil?" (answer: "Vecna" or equivalent) and "Do you promise to defend the good? Promise three times!" (answer: "I promise, I promise, I promise"). A maximum of **two** adventurers can perform the rite. Whoever curses Vecna and promises to save three innocents while bathing in the fountain receives **Tyr's blessing**. The three promised good deeds are hooks for future adventures.
- **Exits:** South (→ Room 7), North (→ Room 9).

Room 9 — The Righteous Shadows

- **Description:** Light source at the center illuminating a stone table surrounded by empty chairs. Shadows move on the walls.
- **Contents:** The shadows solidify into figures of judges and priests of Tyr. They do not speak. Verses carved on the table: "Only the pure can walk in the light, / but even

the shadow of justice can be just. / Only when you understand both, / shall the path be revealed.”

- **Secret:** If the voice of Ormut is with the PCs (they already have the blessing), a **Medaglione della Giustizia** appears on the table (advantage on saving throws against fear/necrotic for 24h). If they attack the shadows: 2 Wraith (CR 5, HP 67) + 3 Spectre (CR 1, HP 22) — HARD.
- **Exits:** South (→ Room 8), North (→ Room 10).

Room 10 — Fresco of the Giant

- **Description:** Fresco of the stone giant defending the temple and the bearer of the Scepter from enemies.
- **Contents:** No treasure or enemies. Narrative element.
- **Exits:** South (→ Room 9), North (→ Room 12).

Room 12 — Room of Sacrifice (passage to Erythale)

- **Description:** Staircase ending against a wall. Magical flame at the center of the room.
- **Contents:** Inscription on the wall: “A’ lammen en’ iand” — “Beyond the threshold” in Elvish (A’ = toward/beyond, Lammen = threshold/door, En’ = of/the, iand = boundary/beyond).
- **Secret — The flame:** Destroying an object of real value to the character in the flame (magic items, keepsakes, many gold coins) grants **Tyr’s blessing**. All PCs can perform this rite. The DM judges whether the sacrifice is genuine.
- **Secret — The wall:** The voice of Ormut guides the PCs (only if they have the blessing). Explains they must run through the wall with faith, without fear of crashing. The wall appears solid if investigated. Aura of abjuration and illusion. Detect Magic reveals the opening. Without the blessing, they cannot pass through.
- **Exits:** South (→ Room 10). Through the wall → **Erythale** (ethereal plane).

DM Notes

Tyr’s Blessings — Three Paths

There are three ways to obtain the blessing, required to access Erythale:

1. **Magnanimity (Room 4)** — Spare/save the golem. One PC only.
2. **Devotion (Room 8)** — Rite at the fountain with Tyr. Maximum two PCs.
3. **Sacrifice (Room 12)** — Burn a valuable object in the flame. All PCs.

Without at least one blessing in the group, the PCs cannot cross the threshold to Erythale.

The Golem After Room 4

If spared, the golem heads to the temple entrance to resume its service. In the **final battle** (Part 5, exiting the temple), it fights alongside the PCs against Alaric and the veterans. It has 50 HP — a powerful but fragile ally.

Final Battle at the Exit

Exiting Room 1 by taking the ascending staircase, the PCs find 15 veterans + Alaric il Giusto arrayed before them. The avatars of Tyr and Vecna observe without intervening. If the PCs use the Sentenza di Tyr or make Alaric confess, the veterans turn against him.

Room 11

Room 11 is not described in the module. The path goes from Room 10 directly to Room 12.

△ Auto-translated from Italian. The Italian version is the source of truth.

Module 3: Return Home

Prelude — After the Temple of Lumina

△ This prelude should be adapted by the DM based on the players' choices in Module B. The module assumes the PCs have the Scepter — if they don't, see the variants below.

After the events at the Temple of Lumina and the clash with Alaric, the PCs return to Baldur's Gate with the Scepter of Tyr (or without it, depending on their choices). Tyr appears in a dream to the herald with clear instructions: the Scepter must be returned to its altar at Svoalbard, in the Far North.

Variants Based on Module B's Ending

If the PCs have the Scepter (options 2 or 4 of Module B): the module proceeds normally. Tyr orders them to bring the Scepter to Svoalbard.

If the PCs gave the Scepter to Alaric (option 1): Tyr appears in a dream, furious. Alaric has been corrupted by the Scepter and is using its power to build an army. The PCs must first track down Alaric (who has retreated to the Ten Towns, his homeland) and recover the Scepter — by force or by cunning. Only then can they proceed toward Svoalbard. The DM must manage this additional quest before starting the journey.

If the PCs destroyed the Scepter (option 3): this module is not played. Tyr is satisfied — the destruction of the Scepter is one of the three good deeds. The PCs can proceed directly to Module D (Malebranche's curse triggers regardless of the Scepter). The DM must find an alternative hook to bring the PCs toward Waterdeep (e.g., Tungsten's wedding, a call for help from Kreig).

Description

The wind from Baldur's Gate harbor carries the smell of brine and tar. The sails of the "Nuova Speranza" swell lazily at anchor, while seagulls screech above the crowded docks. The journey will be long — weeks of open sea, unknown cities, and then the cold of the Far North. But the Scepter of Tyr weighs in your hands more than it should, and the altar awaits you.

The characters are in possession of the Scepter of Tyr, in the herald's hands. They must return it to the altar of Tyr on the island of Svoalbard, north of Bryn Shander. The journey will take them by ship from Baldur's Gate to Luskan (with stops at Waterdeep and Neverwinter), then by sled to Bryn Shander, and finally by sea to Svoalbard. They will be aided by the Custodi dell'Equilibrio (priests of Tyr) and hindered by followers of Vecna: the spy Zalhara Lorenn travels with them on the ship, and the warlock Othran Vorash awaits them in Luskan.

Objective

Reach the island of Svoalbard and return the Scepter of Tyr to its altar. Survive the journey, unmask Vecna's spy, and defeat Othran Vorash.

Prelude — Connection with "Lo Scettro di Tyr"

During the rest in Baldur's Gate, Tyr appears in a dream to the herald, giving them the option to pass the scepter to another member of the group.

"If the weight of the Scepter burdens your spirit, know that Justice does not impose chains: I grant you the right to pass it to whomever you deem worthy. Remember that my blessing shall watch over the one who carries it with a pure heart and unwavering will."

The Scepter of Tyr

The Scepter of Tyr is a divine weapon that channels justice and purity, but is cursed for those who are unworthy. It can only be wielded by Tyr himself and by his herald, who must have proven their purity in the field. If the PCs investigate the scepter with *Detect Magic*, they find among other things the abjuration aura of Tyr's curse. An inscription on the handle in Elvish reads:

"Only the pure are worthy to wield me, cursed by Tyr be the wicked."

The herald can pray to Tyr to reveal the details of the curse. That night Tyr appears in a dream:

"I curse the wicked who dares touch the scepter. Justice shall rise like a burning blade in their dreams. Their life force shall fade day by day, every cure shall be in vain, until death or repentance claims them. Only a sincere act of redemption shall break the mark of my judgment. This is the curse of the Scepter of Tyr."

Magical Properties

- **Sacred Resurrection** (one charge). Functions as the *Resurrection* spell. The Scepter judges the purity of the soul: a corrupted soul cannot be brought back to life. One time only.
- **Empowerment of Justice** (always, passive). All allies within 9m / 30ft / 6sq of the bearer receive: +2 to attack rolls, resistance to necrotic and psychic damage, advantage on saving throws against fear effects.
- **Shield of Purity** (bonus action, 1/day). Force field around the bearer and two allies within 9m / 30ft / 6sq. Reduces all damage taken by half for 3 turns.
- **Sentenza di Tyr** (1/day). The target creature must make a Charisma saving throw (DC 18). Failure: paralyzed for 1 minute, unable to lie or hide its true nature.

The Curse of Tyr

The curse manifests whenever someone takes possession of the Scepter without the consent of the god of Justice.

- An invisible mark (perceptible by clerics of Tyr) seals the intruder's soul. Recurring nightmares, oppressive visions, reduced ability to rest and heal. Recovers only half HP after a long rest; potions and *Cure Wounds* do not work. The effect begins and lasts 24 hours even just from attempting to take the scepter, without succeeding.
- If one continues to possess the scepter, each day maximum HP are halved until the bearer dies.
- The effect ends only when the Scepter is returned **and** the offender performs a sincere act of repentance and redemption.
- Only the most powerful wizards (including Vecna) can avoid the effects. There is no other way.

Internal Locations

Intro — Baldur's Gate

The characters are considered heroes by the Custodi dell'Equilibrio for having saved the scepter from Vecna's clutches. **Helmut Van Heuten** (human commoner, lawful good), a wealthy merchant devoted to Tyr, contacts them to help. Famous for his numerous trade dealings and contacts throughout the Faerûn, Helmut receives the characters in an elegant meeting hall at his residence in Baldur's Gate. With great generosity he distributes scrolls of parchment and detailed maps of the northern seas and the frozen lands around Bryn Shander.

The exact location of Svoalbard is unknown: it is only known to be "north of Bryn Shander." Helmut provides information to reach the dock from which the **Nuova Speranza** will depart, taking them to Luskan. The maps contain directions for mountain passes and safe routes for the sled journey after disembarking, all the way to Bryn Shander. Helmut warns that the journey will last more than a month and that weather conditions in the north are extreme.

Like all followers of Tyr, Helmut knows the legends regarding the altar of Tyr at Svoalbard and the god's presence in that place.

In the city the PCs can stay as long as needed to equip themselves for the long journey.

The book. In one of the cities (Baldur's Gate, Waterdeep, or Neverwinter) the characters can find a book titled "L'altare di Tyr" in a library — they just need to ask the librarian. The book speaks of the Dawnshield family, said to have preserved information about the altar since time immemorial. Upon opening the book they find a **spider** that attacks whoever opens it.

The Nuova Speranza — Crew and Passengers

The commander **Orlomm Glittergear** (neutral good, gnome explorer) announces that the ship will set sail the next day. It will arrive in Luskan in about a month, with stops at Waterdeep (15 days), Neverwinter (10 days), and Luskan (5 days). At each stop there is a one-day layover with departure at dawn. Meals are not included in the ticket.

Crew:

nome	ruolo	stat block	note
Orlomm Glittergear	Captain	Explorer, gnome	Enthusiastic and curious, famous for unknown routes
Goran Stormbridge	First officer	Veteran, human	Gruff but loyal, maintains discipline
Karla Wavecrest	Second officer	Veteran, half-elf	Skilled in navigation and diplomacy
5 Sailors	Crew	Bandit, humans	Delvin, Rurik, Jaana, Sorenn, Vark

Passengers:

nome	stat block	destinazione	note
Hilda Davenport	Commoner, human woman	Waterdeep	Businesswoman, sells fine fabrics
Edgard Flint	Bandit (redeemed), human	Neverwinter	Itinerant merchant, loaded with spices and hides
Zalhara Lorenn	Spy, human woman	Luskan	Vecna's spy (see below)

Zalhara Lorenn — Vecna's Spy

Zalhara claims to be a scholar seeking rare theological texts about Tyr in Luskan. In reality she has been ordered to spy on the characters and report to an emissary of Vecna upon arrival. She possesses a **Ring of the Evanescent Shadow** (refined jade ring, value 75 gp) containing 5 non-rechargeable charges of *Invisibility*. She has an illusion aura.

The spy aims to transmit to Vecna's follower every detail about the nature and protection of the Scepter: who guards it, what powers are known, the journey's stops, and how to avoid the curse. She will attempt to pass information to the local cell at each stop, unless discovered. She doesn't want to spend time with the PCs right after disembarking, precisely for this reason. The contacted local cell will attempt to steal the scepter.

Zalhara knows about the scepter's curse and will not attempt to steal it personally, especially not on the ship. She is looking for a way to avoid the curse, but doesn't know that there is no way other than being as powerful as Vecna himself.

If discovered and interrogated, she won't talk — she is too afraid of Vecna. She only says that it's a job for her and she was paid to watch them, without giving details. She may hint at the scepter's curse without going into specifics.

Around her neck she wears a small worthless ring with a strange spike. Inside it bears an inscription in Common: *"turn left."* It is the key to the trap on the documents.

Searching Zalhara's cabin. If the PCs search her cabin they find documents explaining her mission and how much she was paid (200 gp). The documents are protected by a mechanical explosive trap inside a bag attached under the bed. Investigation DC 12 to find it (automatic if they search the room for more than an hour or more than once at different times).

Explosive Document Trap (Mechanical). A small charge of black powder connected to a spring mechanism in the binder. If opened without the key or the correct procedure, the explosive triggers.

- Anyone within 1.5m / 5ft / 1sq takes 3d6 fire damage. Dexterity saving throw DC 13 to halve. The documents are reduced to ash.
- **Disarming:** Intelligence (Investigation) DC 15 to identify the trigger wire. Then Thieves' Tools DC 15 to disconnect the mechanism (DC 20 without thieves' tools).
- **Key:** The ring around Zalhara's neck. If turned in the wrong direction (the correct one is counterclockwise, "left") it explodes.

Contents of the documents: Zalhara was hired by **Othran Vorash**, a follower of Vecna who is also traveling toward Luskan. Othran departed before the PCs and has a head start of a few days — he is there waiting for information from the spy. Zalhara must gather information without being discovered and hire locals at each stop to attempt to steal the scepter. She is aware of the curse (knows it is deadly, doesn't know the details). She knows the name of the original herald (not the new one, if it was changed).

Sea Conditions (voyage)

For each day of navigation roll 1d20 for sea conditions:

d20	Condition	Description	Effect
1-8	Calm	Nearly flat sea, minimal waves	Smooth navigation, regular speed, minimal risk
9-10	Placid	Light breeze, weak currents	Easy docking, smooth maneuvers
11-16	Slightly rough	Light waves, moderate breeze	Quiet navigation, possible minor delays
17-18	Rough	Medium-high waves, strong winds	Requires attention, possible delays, crew stress
19	Very rough	High waves, strong gusts	Difficult navigation, marked rolling, risk of damage or course deviation
20	Storm	Fierce winds, driving rain	Very high risk of ship damage, need to seek shelter

Seasickness: occurs with conditions from Rough and above. Constitution saving throw with DC per the table below. Conditions change once per day; Rough or higher seas last two days. If they are sick twice in a row they gain one level of Exhaustion, which does not worsen beyond level 2.

Condition	Seasickness DC
Rough (17-18)	DC 10
Very rough (19)	DC 13
Storm (20)	DC 16

Very Rough seas or higher: they lose a day of travel if the captain does not pass a Nature saving throw DC 15. In case of Storm, anyone not in a cabin must make a Dexterity saving throw DC 13 or take 2d4+2 bludgeoning damage (battered on deck).

Voyage: Baldur's Gate → Waterdeep (15 days)

There are no events outside the ship during this leg. The only enemies are boredom and seasickness. The players can get to know the other travelers and, by talking with the crew, learn about the journey's dangers: intense cold in the North, monsters and pirates at sea.

When Zalhara realizes the PCs are gathering to make a plan, she becomes invisible and listens. On one of the following days she attempts to search the PCs' cabin. She will find something or steal something depending on what the players declare they left there.

Stop: Waterdeep

Hilda Davenport bids the characters farewell and disembarks.

If the PCs go out, ask whether they take precautions (if they lock the door and what they leave in the cabin). During the day they are attacked by a gang of criminals who demand they hand over everything. They are looking for the scepter.

Encounter difficulty: EASY

nome	n.	HP	AC	attack	note
Bandit captain	1	65	15	+5, 2d6+3 scimitar	MM p. 344 CR 2
Bandits	5	11	12	+3, 1d6+1 scimitar	MM p. 343 CR 1/8

If searched, they carry a scroll with the PCs' description, the herald's name, and the warning: *"he has a scepter, take it and the 100 gp are yours."*

Zalhara may attempt to search the PCs' cabin. Picking the lock succeeds automatically. Stealth DC 12 with advantage (the crew is bored, not paying attention) to not be seen. Stealth DC 12 to leave no traces of the break-in. If discovered, the guards present tell the PCs that Zalhara explained she mistook the cabin. If she fails the second Stealth check, the door shows obvious signs of forced entry.

In Waterdeep (or alternatively in Neverwinter, not in Luskan) the libraries and the temple of Tyr offer only vague hints about Svoalbard, describing it as a remote island north of Bryn Shander, now shrouded in legend. Searching patiently, the characters discover that the only family that still preserves its memory lives in Bryn Shander: the **Dawnshield family**.

Voyage: Waterdeep → Neverwinter (10 days)

Rougher seas: Very Rough even with a roll of 16 on the die. Frequent seasickness.

Stop: Neverwinter

Edgard Flint bids the characters farewell and disembarks. The PCs can rest and resupply. They are lured into an urban ambush orchestrated by assassins in Vecna's service, in a rough neighborhood near old warehouses. The streets are narrow, some ruined buildings overlook the alleys. It is late evening, the dim lantern light creates many shadows.

Encounter difficulty: MEDIUM

nome	n.	HP	AC	attack	note
Cult Fanatic	1	—	—	—	stat block: Cult Fanatic (CR 4-5), enhanced with <i>Hold Person</i>
Assassin	2	—	—	—	stat block: Assassin (CR 5), targeted sneak attacks
Bandits	3	—	—	—	stat block: Bandit (CR 1), crossbows and daggers

The assassins lure the PCs into a dead-end alley by sending a boy to ask for help with an accident.

As soon as the characters enter the alley, the accomplices drop a barrier of debris to trap them. The two bandits position themselves behind the group with crossbows. They can surprise the PCs if they notice nothing. The Cult Fanatic opens the fight by casting *Hold Person* to isolate a party member. The assassins attack the herald (or whoever they think is the herald) with surprise.

If things go badly for the assassins, they will try to flee by climbing walls or slipping through side passages. Neverwinter's guards intervene if the fight lasts more than four rounds; the assassins will try to slip away before then.

Clues after the fight: on the bodies or among their personal effects, the PCs find (DC 12) the letter of engagement signed "Z" (Zalhara).

Citizens in danger: at the end of the combat, a bystander is trapped in the barrier. If they save him, he turns out to be a native of Bryn Shander, knows the legend of the island, knows the Dawnshield family personally (who live at "via Grande 42" in Bryn Shander), and knows where sleds can be rented.

Tavern “Pelor lo Scintillante.” A room costs 10 gp, 2 gp extra for the spa. In the spa, invigorating drinks are served at 300 gp each that are actually **Potions of Vitality** (remove Exhaustion). Each player can take a maximum of three.

Voyage: Neverwinter → Luskan (5 days)

Calm seas for the entire voyage unless a 20 is rolled. The PCs notice the cold intensifying.

With a d20 result of 13–20 (or at the DM’s discretion) they are attacked by pirates.

Pirate attack. A small pirate schooner, faster than the “Nuova Speranza,” approaches using a light morning fog. The pirates do not aim for a fight to the death: hit hard and vanish with the loot.

Encounter difficulty: HARD

Pirates (attackers):

nome	n.	HP	AC	attack	note
Bandit Captain	1	—	—	—	The leader, stays on the schooner on round 1
Pirate Spellcaster	1	—	—	—	stat block: Mage, stays on the schooner
Base Pirates	10	—	—	—	stat block: Bandit, sabers and crossbows

Defenders of the “Nuova Speranza”: Goran Stormbridge (Veteran), Karla Wavecrest (Veteran), 5 Sailors (Bandit), the PCs. Captain Orlomm retreats to the command cabin to steer the ship to its destination. The other passengers lock themselves below deck.

Pirate tactics. The pirates throw harpoons and ropes to hook the hull. In moments 6 pirates climb aboard, while the Bandit Captain initially stays on the schooner. After one round the captain and the 6 attacking pirates are on the ship; the mage and three pirates remain at 10m / 35ft / 7sq on the other ship (the mage casts spells, the pirates fire crossbows). They aim to raid the hold, steal valuable objects (if they see the scepter — remember the curse), and prevent the defenders from working the sails.

If the Bandit Captain sees his men in trouble, he orders disengagement: the pirates retreat on the ropes, throwing incendiary barrels or smoke bombs to cover the escape. If the defenders repel the assault in more than five rounds, the ship has sustained damage (cut sails, damaged masts, wounded sailors) and must stop for a day on the coast.

Encounter: Pack of Dire Wolves. This encounter occurs during the coastal stop (if the ship is damaged) or during the sled journey toward Bryn Shander.

Encounter difficulty: MEDIUM

nome	n.	HP	AC	attack	note
Dire Wolf	2	—	—	—	MM p. 327, CR 1 each
Wolf	4	—	—	—	MM p. 327, CR 1/4 each

The area is a stretch of rocky coast with small trees and shrubs. A narrow path runs between the cliff and a grove of conifers. The wolves attack in pairs those they consider weakest. The dire wolves attack once the enemy is already engaged, or by surprise.

Ludmilla Dawnshield. With Perception DC 12 (or passive perception) the PCs hear a moan and find **Ludmilla Dawnshield** (human female in her twenties, explorer), wounded in a tree. Her ship was wrecked and she needs to return to her family. She is part of the family the PCs are looking for. If the encounter occurs during the overland/sled journey, she was returning home and got lost.

Stop: Luskan

Zalhara Lorenn bids the PCs farewell (if she hasn't been discovered) and disembarks. The PCs can rest and resupply. Objective: find and pay for a sled. Nothing particular happens. Luskan is a small town, there are no libraries or clerics.

Handing the spies over to the authorities may be the reason they are later attacked, or simply because the spies did not return.

Voyage: Luskan → Bryn Shander (5 days, by sled)

Disembarked from the “Nuova Speranza” at the gates of the Far North, the adventurers set out on a sled across the frozen, snow-covered expanses, until they reach Bryn Shander, in the merciless region of Icewind Dale.

Environmental conditions: if they haven't prepared, at night they may gain levels of Exhaustion (Constitution saving throw DC 12). Each day roll d20 DC 10: failure means fog, with disadvantage on ranged attack rolls.

They may encounter the wolves (if not already done) and therefore Ludmilla.

Young White Dragon. As the characters cross a snowy valley, they come upon signs of an ancient dragon lair: enormous clawed prints in the frost and animal carcasses covered in ice. The weather grows harsher and a glacial haze envelops the area. Suddenly, from a crevice among the rocks, a young white dragon emerges.

Encounter difficulty: HARD

nome	n.	HP	AC	attack	note
Young White Dragon	1	133	17	Bite, Claws, Cold Breath	MM p. 88, CR 6

The dragon ambushes from atop a rocky ledge, spitting a freezing breath before gliding among the PCs. It is hungry and aggressive, but not suicidal: if the battle turns against it, it will attempt to retreat by flight.

Treasure: by investigating the small cave that serves as the dragon's lair, with DC 14 (or by staying there more than 5 minutes) the PCs find a **Warhammer +1** stained with frost and dried blood, and a jade pendant worth 20 gp.

Arctic atmosphere: deep snow and ice sheets make movement risky (sometimes a Dexterity check to avoid slipping).

Encounter with Othran Vorash (first). On the last day of travel the PCs encounter **Othran Vorash** and 5 **cult fanatics**. Othran demands they hand over the scepter. If the PCs refuse, they are attacked.

Encounter difficulty: HARD

nome	n.	HP	AC	attack	note
Othran Vorash	1	84	15	+7, Eldritch Blast 2×(1d10+4 force)	see full stat block below
Cult Fanatic	5	—	—	—	stat block: Cult Fanatic

Othran attacks from range. At the first wound he flees cursing the PCs, leaving the cultists who fight to the death. On one of the bodies (DC 12) a note is found: *"they are heading to Bryn Shander to the Dawnshield family."*

Othran Vorash will secretly follow the PCs on the journey to Svoalbard.

Stop: Bryn Shander

Upon arriving in Bryn Shander, the PCs must find information about Svoalbard. If they have Ludmilla with them, she takes them directly to the family. Otherwise everyone in town knows the Dawnshields, and the PCs may already know the address (via Grande 42) from the bystander saved in Neverwinter.

The Dawnshield family is known as ancient devotees of Tyr. They are said to descend from the first explorers who reached and described Svoalbard. They have always kept the exact details of the route and the island's layout secret, for fear that unscrupulous adventurers or followers of Vecna might desecrate the sacred sites.

Once found and convinced of the group's good faith, the Dawnshields provide crucial directions on how to get there and warn about the journey's dangers.

Ludmilla Dawnshield (human female, explorer). Wears a pendant around her neck with the family crest: a set of scales superimposed on a stylized ocean wave. She explains that the island never stays in the same place — only those who know the family's secret can navigate there without getting lost among the ice. The Dawnshields periodically make pilgrimages to the altar of Tyr on Svoalbard. Ludmilla has made that journey several times.

She is not willing to reveal the secrets lightly, but the PCs can push her to trust them by demonstrating they act in Tyr's name and showing her the scepter, which she clearly recognizes.

Lanterna dell'Aurora. Kept by the family, it glows more intensely as one approaches the island, but only if the traveler is at peace with Tyr. The PCs' faith and actions affect the Lantern's accuracy: anyone who is not "purified" or favored by Tyr will see the flame clouded and be more likely to go astray.

Mechanics: the bearer of the Lantern rolls Nature DC 14 once per day. The herald and Ludmilla roll with advantage; the herald has an additional +2 due to the scepter. If the roll succeeds, the day counts as effective travel; otherwise it is lost. In total the journey to Svoalbard takes 5 days. A faithful of Tyr rolls without disadvantage; someone with doubts or not considered "just" rolls with disadvantage and –1.

Ludmilla offers to guide them with her ship (small vessel for 10 passengers).

Navigation to Svoalbard (5 days)

The party is followed by Othran Vorash. Perception DC 19 to notice a ship in the distance that seems to be following them.

During the navigation the PCs may encounter one or more of these sea monsters, individually of medium or low difficulty but dangerous in hostile weather conditions and with the risk of falling into freezing water:

nome	n.	HP	AC	CR	note
Sahuagin	2d4	22	12	1/2	MM p. 263. Emerge at night, climb the hull
Merrow	1-2	45	13	2	MM p. 219. Patrol territory in murky waters
Quippers (swarm)	1	13	13	1	MM p. 338. Surround anyone who falls overboard
Ice Mephit	2-3	21	11	1/2	MM p. 215. Create freezing mist above the ship
Sea Hag	1	52	14	2	MM p. 179. Appears as humanoid wreckage, curses
Giant Octopus	1	52	11	1	MM p. 326. Wraps the rudder from floating ice

Svoalbard — Othran Vorash's Ambush

When the characters land on the island of Svoalbard, Othran Vorash has arrived before them thanks to a faster ship and has prepared an ambush in a small frozen cove among the coastal rocks. With him hide three undead creatures under his command.

A narrow beach of black ice, with jagged cliffs behind. The arctic wind howls, lifting gusts of snow that reduce visibility and make the ground slippery. Here and there, blocks of floating ice obstruct the landing, forcing them to disembark at a specific point.

Encounter difficulty: DEADLY (CR 10 overall)

nome	n.	HP	AC	attack	note
Othran Vorash	1	84	15	+7, Eldritch Blast 2×(1d10+4 force)	see full stat block
Wight	3	—	—	—	MM p. 302, can turn corpses into zombies, longbows at range

Combat tactics:

1. **Coordinated initial attack.** Othran and the Wights have positioned themselves at elevated points or behind boulders. The warlock waits for the ideal moment to strike with *Hold Monster* or *Fear*, trying to break the group's cohesion. The Wights fire arrows or advance stealthily.
2. **Exploit mobility.** Othran has *Misty Step* and high Dexterity: he avoids melee, moves constantly using natural cover while the Wights keep the strongest PCs engaged.
3. **Use of Counterspell.** If he sees a caster preparing an important spell, Othran spends a 5th-level slot for *Counterspell*.
4. **Coordination with the Wights.** The Wights have necrotic resistance and poison immunity. If a PC goes down, they will try to finish them off to turn them into a zombie.
5. **Retreat or last resort.** If the battle turns against him, Othran attempts to retreat with *Misty Step*. If cornered, he throws all resources (repeated Eldritch Blast, spells) trying to deal as much damage as possible.

Clues about Vecna: on Othran's body (or among his belongings) there may be scrolls with explicit instructions from Vecna.

Collateral damage: the PCs' boat sustains damage from the released energies, forcing them to find another way to continue.

Finale

The altar of Tyr rises at the center of a sanctuary, illuminated by blue torches that flicker in the freezing air. On either side of the hall, statues of paladins with chipped swords seem to watch you in silence, like faceless judges. At the center, a great symbol of Tyr is carved into the floor and, before it, a shallow basin filled with clear water reflects everything like a mirror. Approaching, one notices a brief inscription urging the pilgrim to wash the lies from their heart and lay the Scepter upon the sacred stones.

The moment a character immerses their hands in the water to purify themselves, an echo of footsteps resounds in the room and illusory projections appear showing past injustices or hidden secrets. The group must confront these visions: for every deception or hidden guilt that is not confessed or repaired, the water in the basin darkens and the symbol of Tyr begins to crack. When the characters demonstrate they have faced their own faults, the illusion vanishes.

At that point the Scepter is placed on the altar; the blue flames intensify and a luminous figure — perhaps Tyr’s emissary — appears to receive it. Only then, if every lie has been dispelled, a voice is heard speaking words of approval, and light fills the crypt: the Scepter is lifted in a golden beam, marking the end of the curse and the beginning of a new chapter.

The voice of Tyr echoes in the characters’ minds:

“Balance has been restored and my justice has prevailed over every lie. Yet the shadows of Vecna already stretch across the realms, lying in wait. Await a sign from me, o faithful of the light: when the hour comes, you shall raise your swords to annihilate the dark hunger of the God of Secrets. Place your courage in me, for the law shall never be broken.”

At the bottom of the basin the PCs find a **Spellguard Shield**.

item	type	rarity	bonus	note
Spellguard Shield	Armor (Shield)	Very Rare (requires attunement)	+2	Advantage on saving throws against spells and magical effects. Spell attacks against you have disadvantage.

Enemies

Othran Vorash

Half-elf warlock of Vecna lv10, CR 8. Full stat block: see `characters/markdown/NPC_OthranVorash.md`.

Othran Vorash's Plan

Othran is a faithful servant of Vecna, thirsting for forbidden knowledge and eager to seize the Scepter of Tyr to strengthen his own power. He sent Zalhara Lorenn as a spy to monitor the group, morally and physically weaken the characters by sabotaging the journey, and intervene at the right moment. Othran waits in secret at Luskan; as soon as Zalhara alerts him to a moment of vulnerability, he will strike with his acolytes.

If everything fails and the PCs reach Svoalbard, Othran attempts one last desperate move: appear at the sacred site and use his powers to seize the Scepter, trusting in an artifact or ritual that might mitigate the curse. His final gamble reveals how far he is willing to go for glory (or madness) in Vecna's service.

Key Clues

1. The documents in Zalhara's cabin reveal Othran Vorash's name, his plan, and knowledge of the scepter's curse.
2. The letter of engagement signed "Z" found on the assassins in Neverwinter connects Zalhara to the attacks.
3. The bystander saved in Neverwinter knows the Dawnshield family and their address in Bryn Shander.
4. The book "L'altare di Tyr" (available in the libraries of Baldur's Gate, Waterdeep, or Neverwinter) mentions the Dawnshield family as keepers of information about the altar.
5. The note found on the cult fanatics confirms that Othran knows about the Dawnshield family.
6. The Lanterna dell'Aurora is the only way to find Svoalbard, which never stays in the same place.

Rewards

- **Warhammer +1** (young white dragon's lair)

- Jade pendant (20 gp, dragon's lair)
 - **Spellguard Shield** — Very Rare, requires attunement (basin at the altar of Tyr)
 - **Ring of the Evanescent Shadow** from Zalhara (jade ring, 75 gp, 5 non-rechargeable charges of *Invisibility*)
 - Loot from defeated bandits and pirates
 - Potions of Vitality (purchasable at the tavern "Pelor lo Scintillante" in Neverwinter, 300 gp each)
-

Milestone

No level advancement — the PCs remain at level 10. Returning the Scepter is the narrative reward of the module.

DM Notes

This adventure is a long journey with many stops. Pacing is fundamental: alternate moments of tension (ambushes, pirates, dragon) with moments of respite (city stops, NPC interactions). Not every stop needs a combat — boredom and seasickness on the ship are full-fledged enemies.

Zalhara is the thread running through the first half of the journey. The DM must manage her carefully: she should not be discovered too early (it would trivialize the ambushes at Waterdeep and Neverwinter) nor too late (the players need the satisfaction of unmasking her). The documents in her cabin are the key — let the players find them if they actively search.

Othran Vorash appears three times: as a name in Zalhara's documents, in the encounter before Bryn Shander (where he flees immediately), and in the final ambush at Svoalbard. His presence should build gradually from abstract threat to concrete enemy.

The Lanterna dell'Aurora introduces an interesting mechanic for the journey to Svoalbard: it's not just a die roll, but a test of the group's moral consistency. The DM can use failures to create roleplay scenes where the PCs confront their own choices.

The finale at the altar is a pure roleplay scene. The illusory visions should recall real moments from the campaign — lies told, questionable choices, moral compromises. It is not a combat: it is a reckoning with oneself.

△ Auto-translated from Italian. The Italian version is the source of truth.

Module 4: The End Does Not Belong to the Dead

Prelude — After Svoalbard

△ This prelude should be adapted by the DM based on how Module C concluded and the time elapsed.

After returning the Scepter to the altar of Tyr at Svoalbard (or after the destruction of the Scepter in Module B), the PCs make their way back south. The return journey is long but uneventful — Vecna has lost his main instrument (Othran) and for now retreats into the shadows.

Meanwhile, in Orcastle things have changed. The fall of the magical dome (if the PCs used the scroll in Module A) or the weakening of Malebranche allowed the prisoners to rebel. **Kreig Highlander** — now **Count Wildforge** (he took back the family surname, abandoning the gang's name) — has taken control of the county with **Miranda** and **Ruby** as vassals, old rivalries set aside by the need to rebuild.

Frankie and **Ombrascura**, having separated from the PCs after the escape from Orcastle, stayed in the county to help with reconstruction. They witnessed Malebranche's desperation and his ritual to summon Zikle before he fled to Ulubin — that is how they know about the curse.

Weeks pass, perhaps months. The PCs receive the invitation to **Tungsten's** wedding in Waterdeep and set out along the Sword Coast. It is during this journey that Malebranche's curse begins to manifest.

Description

The Sword Coast stretches before you, jagged with wind-battered cliffs and dense forests that open onto flowering clearings. The sea breeze mingles with the scent of flowers and bark. The paths are silent, but as the sun sets something changes in the air. Whispers carried by the wind, shadows among the ruins. It is not uncommon to find fresh tracks in the mud — bandits or creatures of the night walk this same road.

Malebranche was defeated and driven from Orcastle, but in desperation he performed one last act of vengeance: a ritual that summoned **Zikle**, the extremely powerful 15th-level wizard who authored the scroll of judgment (the one that had created the dome over Orcastle). Malebranche subjugated him and through him cast a curse on his enemies.

Malebranche has taken refuge in **Uluvin**, a small village in the Delimbiyr Vale, not too far from his county and close to Waterdeep. He lives in a shack outside the village under a false identity. In town they know he arrived only a few months ago — the dates coincide with the flight from Orcastle — and he rarely visits the village. A couple of commoners could testify, not too easily, that near his house they saw him performing rituals. Since then they have been afraid and have not approached again. Only Zikle knows that Malebranche is hiding there.

The characters, victorious, are traveling toward Waterdeep for the wedding of **Tungsten**, who has left the radiant citadel, moved to the Sword Coast, and opened a tavern — **All'orco che rutta** — together with **Grimilda**, the bearded dwarf woman he is about to marry. They are coming from the north, a considerable time after the fall of Orcastle and the delivery of the scepter to Tyr.

The curse begins to manifest along the journey: the dead rise wherever the PCs pass, healing is halved, and people begin to fear them.

Malebranche's Curse

The curse has four effects:

1. Around the PCs, in a 10 km area, every living creature has disadvantage on saving throws against necromantic spells. Undead receive advantage on attack rolls and against Turn Undead.
2. Creatures that die automatically become undead after 1 round from death (1d20: 19-20 ghouls, even skeletons, odd zombies), unless they were killed by a radiant effect or specific spells. If killed directly by the PCs they become **ghouls**. Undead that survive a day acquire this same effect on those they kill: the contagion spreads quickly.

3. Any healing or regeneration effect is halved.
4. Undead receive advantage against Turn Undead.

Clues for the Main Quest

The clues guiding the PCs toward discovering the curse and its resolution are scattered throughout the module:

- **Unusual zombies** — The undead that awaken do not seem summoned by a traditional necromancer. They bear the same wounds as when they died and some seem almost startled or confused before becoming aggressive. Investigation or Arcana DC 12 to notice this.
- **Local testimonies** — Village inhabitants begin to fear the adventurers. A child says: *“My father says that wherever you go, the dead rise!”*
- **An arcane symbol on the victims** — Examining the bodies of the undead, one can notice a hidden magical mark on the skin or bones (Investigation DC 13), with runes meaning “torment” and “curse” (Arcana DC 17).

Characters Involved

- **Frankie and Ombrascura** — Escaped from Orcastle, they witnessed Malebranche’s ritual. They join the protagonists to help repair the disaster. Ombrascura, a cleric, has discovered that his blessing barely works: undead have advantage against Turn Undead.
- **Kreig Wildforge** — Rose to power after Malebranche’s fall, attempting to rebuild the county. Harbors an inevitable fear that evil may return. Cooperates by providing shelter and information. **Miranda** and **Ruby** are his trusted vassals.
- **Zikle** — Died deceived and forced to serve his killer. The wraith responds reluctantly, but is the only one who knows the formula to break the curse. Desires vengeance and redemption.
- **Malebranche** — Thirsting for pure destruction, he no longer seeks power over the realm: he only wants to wipe out anyone who prevented him from achieving his goals.

Objective

Rid yourselves of Malebranche’s curse. If necessary, defeat him once and for all. To do so the PCs must: meet Frankie and Ombrascura, return to Orcastle, summon Zikle from his tomb, recover the Monile d’Oro di Ostegard from the Sunken Sanctuary, and perform the ritual to dissolve the curse.

Internal Locations

On the Road — Sword Coast

The journey along the Sword Coast is punctuated by small villages, some still inhabited by farmers and fishermen, others reduced to ruins overgrown with weeds. Old wooden signs creak in the wind before abandoned taverns, dried-up wells, and time-worn statues. Some settlements were abandoned due to wars or pirate raids, others are said to have been cursed by restless spirits.

Three encounters mark the journey and introduce the curse. In all three cases, slain enemies rise as undead according to the curse's rules.

First Encounter — The Bandits

Along the road the PCs encounter a group of desperate bandits looking for travelers to rob. The encounter is easy, but the instant transformation of the fallen into ghouls introduces the curse.

Encounter difficulty: EASY (5-6 PCs lv10)

nome	n.	HP	AC	attack	note
Bandit	4	11	12	+3, 1d6+1 scimitar	CR 1/8
Bandit Captain	1	65	15	+5, 2d6+3 scimitar	CR 2, Multiattack

The fallen transform into **Ghoul** (CR 1) after 1 round.

Second Encounter — The Goblins in the Village

A ruined village opens before you. The houses are gutted, the roofs collapsed. Among the rubble, yellow eyes watch you.

A village raided by goblins. Perception DC 15 to notice being watched; if failed, the PCs are attacked by surprise with arrows.

Encounter difficulty: EASY (5-6 PCs lv10)

nome	n.	HP	AC	attack	note
Hobgoblin	3	11	18	+3, 1d8+1 longsword	CR 1/2, Martial Advantage
Goblin	6	7	15	+4, 1d6+2 shortbow	CR 1/4, Nimble Escape

It is the end of the day: the PCs could take a rest.

Third Encounter — The Gnolls at the Bridge

Streams of clear water descend from the hills, plunging into small hidden lakes. A small moss-covered stone bridge crosses the watercourse. On the other side, bestial figures await you.

The gnolls attack as soon as the PCs cross the bridge.

Encounter difficulty: EASY (5–6 PCs lv10)

nome	n.	HP	AC	attack	note
Gnoll	5	22	15	+4, 1d8+2 spear	CR 1/2, Rampage

After three encounters with dead rising again, the PCs should start asking themselves far more than a few questions.

Meeting Frankie and Ombrascura — Leilon

Shortly after, near **Leilon**, the PCs encounter **Frankie** and **Ombrascura**, who fled the chaos of Orcastle. They recount how Malebranche subjugated Zikle and enacted his vengeance. They have been following the trail of undead and have come this far. The dead increased along the way: they tell of people saying their recently deceased grandparents rose from bed and attacked people.

Leilon

Leilon is a small mining town between Neverwinter and Waterdeep, extending to the Sea of the Dead (so named for the thousands of elves, dwarves, and humans killed by an invading orc army). Behind the town loom the Sword Mountains, inhabited by dwarves.

The burgomaster **Halassiter Arlan** (commoner) informs the PCs of an epidemic of undead creatures in the Warehouse district, which has been quarantined.

Encounter at the Warehouses

The PCs enter a 10×10 warehouse where they find the undead. The door jams shut (crates fall): Strength DC 17 to force it, or 10 minutes to open it.

Encounter difficulty: EASY (5–6 PCs lv10)

nome	n.	HP	AC	attack	note
Ghoul	2	22	12	+4, 2d6+2 claws	CR 1, Paralysis
Ghast	1	36	13	+5, 2d8+3 bite	CR 2, Stench

After the fight they can find clues linking the curse to Zikle's name.

Return to Orcastle — County of Wildforge

With information from Frankie, Ombrascura, and burgomaster Halassiter (who has realized there is an ongoing zombie contagion and that the PCs are somehow responsible), the PCs head toward Orcastle, now administered by Count **Kreig Wildforge** with Miranda and Ruby as vassals. Orcastle is located just south of Waterdeep.

From Kreig they learn that Zikle, after creating the scroll of judgment on Malebranche's behalf, was treacherously killed years earlier. His specter (Wraith) wanders restlessly in a crypt near Orcastle. To communicate with him, the PCs must locate his tomb, perform a summoning ritual, and convince him to explain how to stop the curse.

Zikle's Tomb — Misty Forest

The road winds into paths choked by vegetation. Pines and gnarled oaks line the way, with wild berry bushes and creepers clinging to the remains of ruined dwellings. Hidden by the vegetation, a stone structure long abandoned, with ancient runes and inscriptions.

The tomb is located near the Misty Forest, the foggy forest inhabited by elves and other magical creatures.

When the PCs reach the tomb and summon him, the specters attack by surprise. If the PCs explain why they are there — to get information, defeat Malebranche, lift the curse — the combat subsides.

Encounter difficulty: MEDIUM (5–6 PCs lv10)

nome	n.	HP	AC	attack	note
Wraith (Zikle)	1	67	13	+6, 4d8+3 life drain	CR 5, Incorporeal
Spectre	3	22	12	+4, 3d6 life drain	CR 1, Incorporeal

If the PCs manage to speak with Zikle, the wraith reveals that to break the spell they must sever the bond with Malebranche and recover the **Monile d'Oro di Ostegard**, an ancient talisman that channels the sacred energy needed to disperse the necromantic corruption. The Monile is found in the eponymous sanctuary, protected by concealment enchantments and not marked on any maps. Zikle gives a rough description.

Journey to the Sanctuary

To reach the Sunken Sanctuary of Ostegard, the PCs must navigate with Nature DC 14. If they fail, they get lost and encounter 4 **Ghoul** that attack and fight to the death.

nome	n.	HP	AC	attack	note
Ghoul	4	22	12	+4, 2d6+2 claws	CR 1, Paralysis

The Sunken Sanctuary of Ostegard is an ancient temple now submerged by water in a coastal cavern to the south. Once its location is discovered, Kreig can provide a small boat.

The Sunken Sanctuary of Ostegard

The atmosphere is oppressive. The walls and floor drip with moisture. You descend a staircase and realize the sanctuary is partially flooded. Before you, two stone figures stand motionless in the dark water.

The passage to the central chamber is blocked by an enormous door with three sacred seals that must be activated with a sacred oath. The text is written in Common on the door. Arcana DC 12 to understand the magical meaning of the inscription and the connection between the inscription and the immovable door. The door has no mechanical lock and cannot be opened by any other means.

Encounter difficulty: HARD (5–6 PCs lv10)

nome	n.	HP	AC	attack	note
Stone Golem	2	178	17	+10, 3d8+6 slam	CR 5, Immutable, Magic Resistance

The Oath

"I will fight the death that walks upon the earth and I shall be protected."

The group member who pronounces the oath opens the door. The adventurer now emanates an aura that weakens undead in melee with them, making them easier to fight, but at the same time draws their ire: undead attack them first.

Oath mechanics: - Undead are vulnerable to all attacks from whoever pronounced the oath (duration: 24 hours). - Undead lose all immunities. - Undead attack whoever pronounced the oath first.

The door is very heavy: Athletics DC 15 to open it.

The Guardian of the Monile

The interior of the sanctuary appears as an ancient relic: walls of carved stone with engravings and frescoes of forgotten legends, illuminated by a flickering light that enhances their details. At the center, on a pedestal adorned with arcane symbols, rests the magical monile, whose blue and silver hues seem to pulse with a life of their own. From the dense shadows appears an ethereal guardian with a pale face and melancholic eyes.

The Monile is guarded by **Sir Aldric**, a Sword Wraith (CR 8), a warrior transformed into a vengeful spirit. To convince him to let them pass, the PCs must prove their purity of intent by answering a moral trial.

nome	n.	HP	AC	attack	note
Sword Wraith (Sir Aldric)	1	—	—	—	CR 8, see stat at the end of the source

Sir Aldric says:

"Many call themselves righteous. But the weight of their actions reveals the truth. You have come to claim the Monile, but are you ready to pay the price of your mission? Choose wisely. Do you wish to absolve them, condemn them, or sacrifice yourselves for them?"

Before the PCs, three spirits of their recent victims manifest — real people with a story:

The Coerced Bandit — One of the bandits killed along the road. An armed man, visibly poor, who stole to feed his family.

“Did I truly deserve this condemnation? If you had been in my shoes, what would you have done?”

The Fanatical Cultist — An acolyte of the cult of Dispater, trained since childhood to serve his dark lord. He chose evil, but never had an alternative.

“I was born in darkness. No one ever showed me the light. Is it just to judge a man for the path he could never see?”

The Corrupt Noble — A cruel lord who oppressed his people and funded forbidden rites (may be **Othran Vorash**, the enemy defeated at the end of Lo Scettro di Tyr). He addresses the PCs with a contemptuous sneer:

“I regret nothing. But tell me, didn’t you kill me out of convenience? How much justice was in your hands, and how much vengeance?”

The Door of Choices

The PCs must respond to the spirits’ accusations and then decide their fate:

1. **Absolve them** — They acknowledge the weight of their actions and grant peace to the spirits. Demonstrates mercy, but means coming to terms with forgiving one’s enemies.
2. **Condemn them** — They accept that their choices were just and necessary, declaring that some evils must be eradicated. Demonstrates determination, but could cast a shadow on their soul.
3. **Sacrifice** — An adventurer can choose to take upon themselves part of the curse, becoming a bulwark against necromancy and demonstrating their absolute commitment to the cause.

For each question a designated member of the group must answer. If the answers are all sincere and they accept the consequences of their choices, the door opens and the Monile is accessible. If they lie or refuse to face the trial, Sir Aldric attacks, deeming them unworthy.

To decide if they are lying: either based on what was said (where possible), or by explicitly asking if they are lying — in that case they must pass a Deception DC 18 check.

Enemies

Final Battle — Zikle's Tomb, Misty Forest

Once the Monile is obtained, the Sanctuary begins to be submerged permanently. The PCs must flee.

Malebranche, having learned through his network of spies about the ritual the PCs intend to perform, reaches them at Zikle's tomb in the Misty Forest to try to stop them before they complete the ritual.

Encounter difficulty: DEADLY (5–6 PCs lv10)

nome	n.	HP	AC	attack	note
Malebranche (necromancer wizard)	1	—	—	—	CR 10–11, Legendary Enemy, see stat at the end of the source
Wraith	2	67	13	+6, 4d8+3 life drain	CR 5, Incorporeal
Ghast	2	36	13	+5, 2d8+3 bite	CR 2, Stench
Skeleton	5	13	13	+4, 1d6+2 shortbow	CR 1/4, summoned by Malebranche on his turn

Malebranche's fury and the presence of the summoned undead pose a serious threat to the PCs, who must balance resource use between offense and defense, especially with healing halved.

The Ritual

If the PCs defeat Malebranche, they can perform the ritual to dissolve the curse. The ritual with the Monile d'Oro di Ostegard requires two separate checks, both of which must succeed: first an Arcana DC 12 check to activate the monile's runes, then a Religion DC 12 check to synchronize them with the sacred energy.

After the ritual Zikle appears:

- If they did not pass the checks, he declares himself disappointed but concentrates and allows one of the characters to reroll with advantage.
- If the ritual succeeds, Zikle declares himself satisfied, states that the necromantic power has been dispelled, and vanishes.

- If the ritual still fails, Zikle (Wraith) attacks the PCs in a fury, saying the curse will continue for months because of them.

Key Clues

- The transformation of the fallen into undead during the three travel encounters is the first sign of the curse.
- Local testimonies and the arcane symbol on the victims confirm this is not ordinary necromancy.
- Frankie and Ombrascura provide the direct connection to Malebranche and Zikle.
- Burgomaster Halassiter confirms the contagion and that the PCs are somehow the cause.
- Krieg Wildforge directs the PCs toward Zikle's tomb.
- Zikle reveals the existence of the Monile d'Oro di Ostegard and the location of the Sunken Sanctuary.

Finale

Epilogue — Tungsten's Wedding

Finally the PCs can reach Waterdeep and attend Tungsten's wedding. The celebrations are held at the tavern ***All'orco che rutta*** (Tungsten laughs heartily when he says the tavern's name — it amuses him passionately).

The wedding is a fine party: eating, drinking, dancing. Three events can liven up the evening:

"Brawl" on the menu — There is a bell that the bartender rings and the entire room stands up and starts fighting instantly. Total chaos for a certain number of rounds, then the bell rings again and everyone sits back down to drink as if nothing happened. Tungsten is thrilled with this idea, which his regular patrons also love, and he decided not to give it up to add an extra kick to the wedding celebration. Triggers on 1-3 on d20.

The troublemaking uncle — The bride's uncle is a troublemaker. At some point, drunk, he starts insulting random people just because he feels like throwing punches. Tungsten cries and asks the PCs to resolve the situation "peacefully." They cannot use weapons; if they deal him one hit point of damage he faints.

Grunthor, the ex-boyfriend — Grimilda's orc ex-boyfriend bursts into the room brandishing a bottle as if it were the trophy of the century. Among the murmurs of the bystanders, everyone immediately understands who he is. The drunk orc staggers and slurs:

“Grimilda, time... uh, time has not faded your splendor, you are like a river... an eternal river... (loses his train of thought, takes a sip) ...anyway, run away with me!”

With an icy stare, Grimilda approaches and, without hesitation, pushes him to the ground: Grunthor faints instantly, replacing his words with thunderous snoring.

Rewards

- **Monile d’Oro di Ostegard** — Ancient talisman that channels sacred energy. Used for the ritual to dissolve the curse.
- **Curse removal** — If the ritual succeeds, Malebranche’s curse is dispelled and the undead epidemic ends.
- **Oath aura** — The PC who pronounces the oath in the Sanctuary gains an aura (duration: 24 hours) that makes undead vulnerable to their attacks and causes them to lose all immunities (but undead attack them first).
- **Definitive defeat of Malebranche** — If the PCs defeat him in the final battle, the threat is eliminated forever.

Milestone

No level advancement — the PCs remain at level 10. The defeat of Malebranche and the removal of the curse conclude the saga.

DM Notes

The module’s pacing is divided into three phases: the journey (discovery of the curse), the investigation (Orcastle, Zikle’s tomb, Sanctuary), and the final battle. The first phase must create growing unease — the three travel encounters are easy in themselves, but the transformation of the fallen into undead is the real element of tension.

The PCs should arrive at the final battle with reduced resources. The halved healing from the curse makes every combat more costly than normal. The final battle is rated as DEADLY: Malebranche is a legendary enemy and the presence of summoned undead forces the PCs to balance offense and defense.

The moral trial in the Sanctuary of Ostegard is the narrative heart of the module. There is no “right” answer — all three choices (absolve, condemn, sacrifice) are valid as long as they are sincere. The DM must evaluate the sincerity of the answers based on roleplay or, if necessary, with a Deception DC 18 check.

Waterdeep is described in the source as general context: it is the City of Splendors, cosmopolitan, wealthy, dangerous, governed with an iron fist. Money (the Waterdhavian Dragon) is the true engine of the city. Guilds, nobles, trade consortiums, mercenaries, and criminal groups all have a hidden agenda. Being watched or spied upon is normal. This information is common knowledge for the PCs and requires no checks.

The wedding epilogue is a moment of levity after the module’s tension. The three events (brawl, uncle, Grunthor) are optional and serve to close with a smile. Tungsten is a character who genuinely enjoys himself and the tone should reflect this.

If Zikle attacks after a failed ritual, it is an additional combat not accounted for in the balance — the PCs will likely be in trouble. Consider having Zikle flee after a few rounds or using it as a hook for a future adventure.

△ Auto-translated from Italian. The Italian version is the source of truth.

Sunken Sanctuary of Ostegard — DM Map

Overview

Ancient temple submerged by water, located in a coastal cavern south of Orcastle. Not marked on any maps. Zikle provides a rough description; Kreig Wildforge can provide a small boat to reach it. The sanctuary houses the **Monile d'Oro di Ostegard**, a talisman needed for the ritual to dissolve Malebranche's curse.

The atmosphere is oppressive: walls and floor drip with moisture, the sanctuary is partially flooded.

Layout



Antechamber (entrance)

- **Description:** Descending staircase. Sanctuary partially flooded. Two stone figures standing motionless in the dark water.

- **Contents:** 2 **Stone Golem** (HP 178, AC 17, +10, 3d8+6 slam, CR 5, Immutable, Magic Resistance).
- **Hazards:** HARD encounter for 5-6 PCs lv10.
- **Exits:** Back (staircase to the outside), Forward (sealed door → Central chamber).

Sealed Door

- **Description:** Enormous door with three sacred seals. Text written in Common on the door.
- **Mechanics:** Arcana DC 12 to understand the magical meaning of the inscription and the connection between the inscription and the immovable door. The door has no mechanical lock and cannot be opened by any other means than pronouncing the oath.
- **Oath:** *"I will fight the death that walks upon the earth and I shall be protected."*
- **Effect of the oath:** Whoever pronounces the oath opens the door. They emanate an aura that weakens undead in melee with them (vulnerable to all their attacks, lose all immunities, duration: 24 hours). Undead attack them first.
- **Heavy door:** Athletics DC 15 to open it after pronouncing the oath.

Central Chamber (Monile chamber)

- **Description:** Walls of carved stone with engravings and frescoes of forgotten legends, illuminated by flickering light. At the center, a pedestal adorned with arcane symbols.
- **Contents:** The **Monile d'Oro di Ostegard** rests on the pedestal (blue and silver hues, seems to pulse with a life of its own).
- **Guardian:** **Sir Aldric** (Sword Wraith, CR 8) appears from the shadows. Pale face, melancholic eyes. Poses a moral trial to the PCs before granting the Monile.

Sir Aldric's Moral Trial

Sir Aldric says: *"Many call themselves righteous. But the weight of their actions reveals the truth. You have come to claim the Monile, but are you ready to pay the price of your mission? Choose wisely. Do you wish to absolve them, condemn them, or sacrifice yourselves for them?"*

Three spirits of the PCs' recent victims manifest:

1. **The Coerced Bandit** — A poor man who stole to feed his family. Asks: *"Did I truly deserve this condemnation?"*
2. **The Fanatical Cultist** — An acolyte of Dispat, trained since childhood. Asks: *"Is it just to judge a man for the path he could never see?"*

3. **The Corrupt Noble** — A cruel lord (may be Othran Vorash). Sneering: *“I regret nothing. But tell me, didn’t you kill me out of convenience? How much justice was in your hands, and how much vengeance?”*

For each spirit, a designated member of the group must respond by choosing between:
- **Absolve** — Grant peace. Demonstrates mercy. - **Condemn** — Declare the choice just. Demonstrates determination. - **Sacrifice** — A PC takes upon themselves part of the curse.

If the answers are all sincere and they accept the consequences, the door opens and the Monile is accessible. If they lie or refuse, Sir Aldric attacks. To evaluate sincerity: based on roleplay, or Deception DC 18 if they explicitly declare they are lying.

DM Notes

Final Flooding

Once the Monile is obtained, the Sanctuary begins to be submerged permanently. The PCs must flee quickly.

Access to the Sanctuary

- Not marked on any maps. Zikle gives a rough description.
- To reach it: Nature DC 14 to navigate. If they fail, they get lost and encounter 4 Ghoul (CR 1).
- Kreig Wildforge can provide a small boat.
- Coastal cavern south of Orcastle.

The Moral Trial — Narrative Heart

There is no “right” answer. All three choices (absolve, condemn, sacrifice) are valid as long as they are sincere. The DM must evaluate sincerity based on roleplay. This is not a mechanical puzzle but a moment of character introspection.

Connection to the Final Battle

After the Sanctuary, the PCs head to Zikle’s tomb in the Misty Forest for the ritual with the Monile. Malebranche reaches them there for the final battle.